

Relocating to Türkiye

A practical 90-60-30-day guide for moving to Istanbul

Plan early. Decide with confidence. Arrive ready.

Introduction

A move to Istanbul can feel simple at first. Then the details piled up. Visa questions appear. Housing decisions take time. Budget planning gets real. Arrival tasks start crowding in the final weeks.

That is where a clear relocation checklist helps. This six-part guide breaks the move into manageable stages. Each module focuses on one part of the process, so you can plan early and stay organized from start to finish.

Key takeaways:

- Break the move into clear stages.
- Start early with visas and documents.
- Plan housing before the pressure grows.
- Build a realistic budget.
- Confirm arrival details before departure.

Why Use a Relocation Checklist for Istanbul?

A relocation checklist gives structure to a busy move. It helps you see what comes first and what can wait. That matters when you are planning a long stay or a move to Istanbul, because many tasks depend on earlier ones.

Without a timeline, it is easy to jump between topics. You may think about housing before your budget is ready. You may think about arrival packing before your documents are in order. A checklist keeps those steps in sequence.

It also reduces repeat work. You do not need to rethink the same task every week. You can follow the plan, update it, and move on with more confidence.

What does the full timeline cover?

The series walks through six practical stages:

1. Know your stay type and goals

2. **Handle visas and core documents early**
3. **Plan housing with a clear timeline**
4. **Build a budget for the move and the stay**
5. **Prepare arrival setup and final checks**
6. **Use the full checklist in order**

Each module stands on its own. Together, they create a complete relocation path.

How Should You Use This Six-Part Series?

Start with the first module and move forward in order. Each stage builds on the last one. That order matters because planning early usually makes later decisions easier.

If you are just beginning, read the series from the start. If you are already closer to departure, jump to the module that matches your current stage. The articles are built to be practical either way.

The best way to use the series is simple. Read one module. Apply the checklist. Then move to the next stage.

Who is this series for?

This series is for people planning a move to Istanbul or a long stay in the city. It also helps customers who want a clearer system for visas, housing, budgeting, and arrival setup.

The focus is practical. The goal is not to overwhelm you with options. The goal is to help you move in order.

What Each Module Covers

Module 1: Know Your Stay Type and Goals

This module helps you define the kind of move you are making. It sets the direction for the rest of the checklist. You clarify your stay, your priorities, and the overall shape of the plan.

Module 2: Handle Visas and Core Documents Early

This module walks through the early document stage. It helps you keep visa notes, passport checks, backup copies, and core documents in one place.

Module 3: Plan Housing with a Clear Timeline

This module shows how to research, narrow, and confirm housing on a schedule. It keeps the housing search calm and focused.

Module 4: Build a Budget for the Move and the Stay

This module helps you think through move costs, housing costs, arrival costs, and longer-term spending. It keeps your plan centered on what you can support.

Module 5: Prepare Arrival Setup and Final Checks

This module covers the final month before departure. It helps you organize documents, travel details, housing notes, and first-week reminders.

Module 6: Use the Full Checklist in Order

This module brings the full process together. It shows how to follow the steps in sequence so the move feels easier to manage.

Why Does Order Matter So Much?

Order matters because relocation tasks are connected. One step often depends on another. If you skip ahead, you may create extra work later.

For example, housing decisions usually make more sense when your budget is clear. Arrival planning usually goes more smoothly when your documents are ready. A good timeline keeps those pieces aligned.

That is why this series is built as a sequence, not a random list. It helps you think like a planner, not a problem solver under pressure.

How to Move Through the Checklist Month by Month

A simple way to use the series is to assign each stage to your timeline.

- **90 days before arrival:** Start with visas, documents, and early housing research.
- **60 days before arrival:** Narrow housing, tighten your budget, and continue tracking documents.
- **30 days before arrival:** Confirm the final housing choice, review travel details, and prepare your arrival folder.
- **Final week:** Run the checklist one last time and keep your key items easy to reach.

This rhythm works because it spreads the work out. You do not need to finish everything at once. You only need to keep moving in the right order.

Where MoveToIstanbul Fits In

MoveToIstanbul provides travel and relocation information focused on Türkiye, with an emphasis on moving to and long-term stays in Istanbul. The site offers practical guides, plus concierge and itinerary services to help customers plan relocation and extended visits.

If you want to go deeper, explore these solutions:

- **Visa guides**
- **Housing guides**
- **Cost of living guides**
- **Relocation and long-stay guides for Istanbul**
- **Concierge service**
- **Itinerary planning**
- **Curated local content**

These solutions support the same planning process covered in the series.

Conclusion: Start With One Step, Then Continue in Order

A move to Istanbul feels easier when you break it into stages. That is the point of this series. It gives you a clear path for visas, housing, budgeting, and arrival setup.

Start with the first module. Follow the order. Then move through the rest at your own pace. If you keep the process simple, the move becomes much more manageable.

Master 90–60–30 Day Relocation Checklist

Use this master checklist as the working dashboard for the move. Tick each box when complete, write the owner or deadline in the note's column, and review the table weekly. Visa and residence requirements vary by nationality and purpose of stay, so verify them against current official guidance before acting.

Module	90 days: map and research	60 days: narrow and complete	30 days: confirm and prepare	Status / notes
1. Map the move	☐ Confirm purpose, stay length, move window and priorities ☐ Create one master tracker ☐ Set a weekly review time	☐ Group tasks by category ☐ Update dates and dependencies ☐ Resolve or assign open questions	☐ Confirm all major decisions ☐ Create the final-week sequence ☐ Close or escalate overdue items	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete Notes: _____ –
2. Visas and documents	☐ Verify the correct visa or permit route ☐ Check passport validity ☐ Build a “Have / Still need” inventory ☐ Set up original and backup storage	☐ Gather available records ☐ Obtain, translate or legalize missing items where required ☐ Recheck timelines and fees ☐ Maintain a questions list	☐ Confirm the travel document pack ☐ Check originals and readable backups ☐ Keep key papers accessible ☐ Resolve remaining application items	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete Notes: _____ –
3. Housing	☐ Define stay length, preferred areas and must-haves ☐ Set a	☐ Compare cost, timing, location and stay fit ☐ Remove weak options	☐ Confirm the preferred option ☐ Review terms, dates	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete

	housing budget range ☐ Start one housing tracker ☐ Collect suitable options	☐ Keep a manageable shortlist ☐ Record questions and contact details	and arrival arrangements ☐ Align housing with the move budget ☐ Save final contact and access notes	Notes: -
4. Budget	☐ Draft travel, housing, arrival, living and document costs ☐ Separate one-time and recurring costs ☐ Add a contingency allowance ☐ Identify unknown estimates	☐ Replace estimates with current figures ☐ Test housing affordability ☐ Review currency and payment needs ☐ Adjust the plan where totals are too high	☐ Confirm booked and payable amounts ☐ Reserve first-month funds ☐ Prepare accessible payment methods ☐ Freeze the pre-departure budget baseline	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete Notes: -
5. Arrival setup	☐ Create an arrival folder ☐ Draft a first-week outline ☐ List key contacts and essential information	☐ Add confirmed travel and housing details ☐ Organize backup copies ☐ Identify first-day and first-week priorities	☐ Confirm travel and accommodation details ☐ Pack essential documents for easy access ☐ Finalize the first-week plan ☐ Run the final checklist pass	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete Notes: -
6. Use the full checklist in order	☐ Confirm the sequence: plan → documents → housing → budget → arrival ☐ Assign	☐ Review dependencies across modules ☐ Remove duplicate lists ☐ Focus on	☐ Complete a full readiness review ☐ Prepare a travel-day checklist ☐ Carry	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete Notes:

	owners and due stages ☐ Establish weekly status review	unresolved high-priority items	forward only genuine post-arrival tasks	–
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Add your Notes: -

Module 1: Map the Move Before You Start

Define the move, create one planning system, and establish a weekly review rhythm.

Stage	Detailed actions	How to do each step	Completion evidence
90 days	☐ Confirm move purpose, intended stay, target arrival date and decision-makers ☐ Define non-negotiables and preferences ☐ Create the five workstreams: visas, documents, housing, budget and arrival ☐ Build one master tracker ☐ Schedule a weekly review	Write a one-page move brief answering: why, when, how long, who is moving and what success looks like. Create tracker columns for task, workstream, owner, deadline, dependency, status and notes. Enter every known task, mark assumptions as “verify,” and reserve 20 minutes on the same day each week	Move brief approved; one tracker contains all tasks; owners and first deadlines are visible; weekly review is scheduled.

		for review.	
60 days	☐ Convert broad tasks into specific next actions ☐ Link dependencies ☐ Record decisions and reasons ☐ Assign unresolved items ☐ Create a four-week priority view	Rewrite vague items such as “housing” as clear actions such as “compare five options by total monthly cost.” Add “blocked by” notes. For every open item, assign one owner and one date. Move completed research into a decision log and filter the tracker to show tasks due in the next four weeks.	Each active task starts with a verb, has an owner and date, and shows its dependency; top priorities are visible.
30 days	☐ Freeze major decisions ☐ Review all red or overdue items ☐ Create final-week and travel-day sequences ☐ Prepare backup plans ☐ Remove obsolete tasks	Run a readiness meeting using the five workstreams. Mark every item complete, in progress, blocked or post-arrival. Escalate blocked legal, housing or travel tasks immediately. Build a day-by-day final-week list, create alternatives for critical bookings, and archive tasks that no longer apply.	Only final confirmations remain; critical items have backups; final-week plan is ordered and assigned.

Fillable Template — Module 1: Move Planning

Stage	User input
90 days	Move purpose: _____ Target arrival date: _____ Expected stay length: _____ People moving / decision-makers: _____ Top three non-negotiables: 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____ _____ Master tracker location: _____ Weekly review day and time: _____
60 days	Top five actions for the next four weeks: 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____ 4. _____ 5. _____

	Main dependencies: _____ Blocked tasks and reason: _____ Decision made / reason: _____ Owner and due date: _____
30 days	Major decisions confirmed: _____ Overdue or red items: _____ Backup plans required: _____ Final-week sequence: _____ Travel-day owner / support contact: _____ Overall status: ☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red

What Does a Practical Move Planning Checklist Look Like?

Stage	Checklist action	Your entry	Owner / due date	Status / evidence
90 days	☐ Write the move brief ☐ Confirm arrival date and stay length ☐ List decision-makers and three non-negotiables ☐ Create the master tracker ☐ Schedule the weekly review	Purpose: _____ Arrival: _____ Stay length: _____ Decision-makers: _____ non-negotiables: _____ Tracker location: _____ Review time: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete Evidence: _____ _____
60 days	☐ Confirm the top five actions ☐ Record dependencies and blocked tasks ☐ Document decisions and reasons ☐ Assign every open task	Top actions: _____ Dependencies: _____ Blocked items: _____ Decision / reason: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red Evidence: _____ _____
30 day	☐ Freeze major decisions	Confirmed decisions: _____	Owner: _____	☐ Green ☐

s	☐ Escalate overdue items ☐ Confirm backup plans ☐ Build final-week and travel-day sequences	Red items:	Due:	Amber ☐ Red Evidence:
		Backups:		
		Final-week sequence:		
		Support contact:		

Introduction:

A move to Istanbul can feel bigger than expected. The paperwork sits in one pile. Housing lives in another. Budget questions keep changing.

That is where a simple relocation timeline helps. It gives your move shape before the pressure builds. This article focuses on the first module, mapping the move before you start. You will learn how to organize the process, group tasks, and set a workable 90-, 60-, and 30-day plan.

Why You Need a Move Plan Before You Do Anything Else

A relocation plan is not about making the move perfect. It is about making the move manageable. Istanbul is a city where long-stay planning benefits from structure, especially when you are trying to line up visas, housing, documents, and budget decisions at the same time.

A first draft plan gives you room to think. It keeps your attention on the right order. You begin with the basics, then build from there.

What this planning stage covers

This stage helps you define:

- **Your move window**
- **Your task categories**
- **Your planning priorities**
- **Your weekly review rhythm**

That sounds simple. It should. Simple systems are easier to maintain.

A good early plan also reduces decision fatigue. You do not want to re-decide every action from scratch. Instead, you want one list that holds the whole move together.

How to Think About the 90, 60, and 30 Day Structure

The 90, 60, and 30 day structure works because it separates early exploration from final preparation. At 90 days, you are still mapping. At 60 days, you are narrowing. At 30 days, you are confirming.

That order matters. If you handle final details too early, you waste time. If you wait too long, you create pressure. A staged plan keeps both problems under control.

90 days before arrival

This is your broad planning phase. You are not trying to finish every task. You are trying to understand what must happen before departure.

Focus on:

- Getting your main relocation categories in place
- Identifying what you still need to learn
- Creating a rough task list
- Tracking unresolved questions

60 days before arrival

This is your refinement phase. You should now know the shape of your move. Your job is to remove uncertainty where possible.

Focus on:

- Sorting tasks into clearer groups
- Updating notes and reminders
- Narrowing options
- Adjusting your schedule based on what you have learned

30 days before arrival

This becomes your readiness phase. Big decisions should already be made. Your task list should now feel practical and specific.

Focus on:

- Checking what is still open
- Confirming key details

- Preparing arrival materials
- Reviewing your final week in sequence

Create the Five Core Planning Categories

A strong relocation checklist works best when it is grouped correctly. For an Istanbul move, five categories give you a clean starting point.

1. Visas

Visa planning deserves early attention because it affects many other parts of the move. If your stay requires paperwork or timing decisions, that should appear near the top of the plan.

2. Housing

Housing affects your arrival experience, your timeline, and your budget. It should not sit in a random task pile.

3. Documents

Documents are easy to overlook until they become urgent. Keep them in one category so you can track them early.

4. Budgeting

Budgeting gives you a realistic picture of what the move can support. It also helps you compare housing and arrival choices with more confidence.

5. Arrival Setup

Arrival setup covers the last stage of the move. It includes the practical details you want ready before you land in Istanbul.

A checklist with these five buckets is easier to use. It also makes weekly review more productive.

Build Your Master Checklist in One Place

A master checklist is your working map. It should hold every task you care about in one list, even if you later sort it into phases.

You can use a notes app, a spreadsheet, or paper. The tool matters less than consistency. What matters is that you can see the full move at a glance.

How to set it up

Use these columns:

- **Task**

- **Category**
- **Due date**
- **Status**
- **Notes**

That format keeps the list readable. It also helps you spot gaps fast.

Example checklist items

- Review visa guidance
- Check passport status
- Gather document copies
- Research housing options
- Draft move budget
- Create arrival notes

These are not final answers. They are starting points. A good checklist begins with broad items and becomes more specific over time.

What to Put in Your 90-Day Planning List

The 90-day stage is where you shape the move. You want a visible plan before smaller issues take over.

Your 90-day priorities

Begin by reviewing the main parts of the move. At this stage, your goal is awareness, not completion.

Include tasks such as:

- Reviewing visa guidance
- Listing required documents
- Researching housing
- Reading cost of living information
- Drafting a move budget
- Creating a basic arrival note
- Setting a weekly review time

Those tasks help you understand the move without overcommitting too early.

Why this stage matters

Early planning gives you space. It lets you compare options without panic. It also makes later tasks easier, because you are building from an organized base.

A customer who starts early can adapt. A customer who starts late has less room to move.

What to Refine at 60 Days

The 60 day mark is where your planning becomes more practical. Your task list should now reflect what you have learned.

Your 60 day priorities

At this point, move from broad ideas to more defined actions:

- Sort documents into a keep and still-needed list
- Narrow housing options
- Update budget figures
- Add arrival details to your notes
- Revisit any open visa questions
- Check whether your timeline still fits your move date

This stage should reduce uncertainty. It should not create new confusion.

How to know you are on track

You are on track when:

- Your tasks are grouped clearly
- You can explain the next three steps
- Your housing notes are more focused
- Your budget feels usable, not vague

If the list still feels scattered, simplify it. Remove anything that does not support the move directly.

What to Confirm at 30 Days

The final month before arrival is not for a full reset. It is for confirmation. You want to check readiness and tighten loose ends.

Your 30 day priorities

Use this stage to:

- Confirm document readiness
- Recheck visa-related items
- Review housing details
- Finalize your budget
- Prepare arrival notes
- Create a first-week plan

This is where your structure pays off. You should already know what matters. Now you are just making sure it is ready.

What not to do at 30 days

Do not rebuild the entire plan.

Do not reopen every decision.

Do not let new questions erase your progress.

Stay focused on final checks. That keeps the move calm and clear.

How to Review Your Checklist Each Week

A checklist only works if you look at it often. Weekly review keeps the plan alive.

Simple review routine

1. Open your master list.
2. Mark completed tasks.
3. Move active items into this week's focus.
4. Remove anything no longer needed.
5. Add new details only when they fit the move.

This takes only a few minutes. It can save hours later.

A useful rule

If a task has stayed untouched for weeks, ask why.
If it no longer supports the move, drop it.
If it still matters, move it closer to the top.

That keeps your list honest.

Common Planning Mistakes to Avoid

Early relocation planning can go wrong in small ways. These mistakes are common, and they are easy to fix.

Mistake 1: Keeping too many separate lists

A scattered system creates more work. One master list is usually better.

Mistake 2: Waiting to group tasks

If you do not categorize early, the move feels more chaotic later.

Mistake 3: Planning only for departure

Arrival matters too. Set up your first-week notes before you travel.

Mistake 4: Letting budget sit too loosely

A budget should guide decisions. It should not stay vague for long.

Mistake 5: Ignoring weekly review

A checklist cannot help if it never gets updated.

Avoiding these mistakes keeps the move steady.

Conclusion: Start Small, Then Build

A move to Istanbul becomes easier when you start with a clear plan. The goal of this first module is simple, map the move before you start making final decisions.

Use the 90-, 60-, and 30-day structure. Group your tasks. Review your checklist weekly. Keep the list practical. That gives you a strong base for the rest of your relocation planning.

Did you do the work?

Write note from Module-1 :-

Module 2: Visas and Core Documents

Stage	Detailed actions	How to do each step	Completion evidence
90 days	☐ Identify the correct entry and stay route for nationality and purpose ☐ Check passport validity against the intended stay ☐ Build a document requirement register ☐ Identify translation, apostille or legalization needs ☐ Create secure original and backup storage	Use official Turkish foreign-affairs and migration information only. Record the source, check date, route, stay limit and next action. Compare passport expiry with the planned stay. List every required item with issuer, format, validity, translation requirement, owner and due date. Store originals in a labeled folder and readable scans in two secure locations.	Chosen route and assumptions are documented; passport check is complete; each document is marked have, requested, translated, legalized or missing.
60 days	☐ Order missing civil, employment, study or financial records as applicable ☐ Complete required translation or legalization steps ☐ Check application timing, fees and appointment process ☐ Review health-insurance or proof-of-address needs if relevant ☐ Maintain a questions and evidence log	Contact the issuing authority for every missing record and note delivery time. Use authorized providers where the official requirement calls for translation or legalization. Recheck current instructions before paying or booking. Save receipts and confirmations with the related document. Write unanswered questions in a log and resolve them through official channels.	No undocumented gaps; pending documents have expected dates; required appointments or applications are scheduled; receipts are filed.

30 days	☐ Revalidate requirements and deadlines ☐ Assemble the travel document pack ☐ Verify names, dates and document consistency ☐ Prepare paper and offline digital copies ☐ Close remaining application actions	Repeat the official-source check because rules can change. Compare spelling, passport number and dates across forms and bookings. Order the pack: passport, visa or permit evidence, travel details, accommodation evidence and supporting records. Keep originals in hand luggage and make key scans available offline without exposing them publicly.	Complete indexed pack; consistent personal details; current requirements confirmed; no unresolved critical action.
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Fillable Template — Module 2: Visa and Documents

Stage	User input
90 days	Nationality: _____ Purpose of stay: _____ Planned arrival / departure: _____ Entry or stay route to verify: _____ Official source checked / date: _____ Passport expiry: _____ Documents required: _____ Translation / legalization needs: _____ Original storage: _____ Backup storage: _____
60 days	Missing document: _____ Issuing authority: _____ Requested on: _____ Expected by: _____ Translation / legalization provider: _____ Application or appointment date: _____ Fee and payment status: _____ Insurance / address evidence needed: _____ Open question / official response: _____
30 days	Requirements rechecked on: _____ Names, dates and passport number verified: ☐ Yes ☐ No Travel pack contents: _____ Paper copies location: _____

Offline copies location: _____
Remaining action / owner / deadline: _____
Overall status: ☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red

What Does a Practical Visa and Document Checklist Look Like?

Sta ge	Checklist action	Your entry	Owner / due date	Status / evidenc e
90 day s	☐ Record nationality, purpose and travel dates ☐ Verify the entry or stay route ☐ Check passport expiry ☐ List required documents ☐ Identify translation or legalization needs ☐ Set original and backup storage	Nationality: _____ Purpose: _____ Dates: _____ Route / source / checked date: _____ Passport expiry: _____ Required documents: _____ Translation needs: _____ Storage: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete Evidence : _____ -
60 day s	☐ Request missing documents ☐ Arrange translation or legalization ☐ Record appointment and fees ☐ Confirm insurance or address	Missing item / issuer: _____ Requested / expected: _____ Provider: _____ Appointment: _____ Fee status: _____ Open question / response: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red Evidence : _____ -

	evidence if applicable ☐ Resolve open questions			
30 days	☐ Recheck current requirements ☐ Verify names, dates and passport number ☐ Assemble paper and offline packs ☐ Close remaining critical actions	Rechecked on: _____ Details verified: ☐ Yes ☐ No Pack contents: _____ Paper location: _____ Offline location: _____ Remaining action: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red Evidence : _____ _____

Important: Confirm current requirements through the Republic of Türkiye's official foreign affairs and migration channels. The applicable route can differ by nationality, purpose and intended length of stay.

Introduction:

Visa planning can turn a calm move into a rushed one. Core documents can do the same. A lot of people wait until the final weeks to deal with both, then lose time searching for papers, checking details, and fixing gaps.

That pressure is avoidable. A simple early system keeps the process manageable. It helps you see what you need, what you already have, and what still needs attention before you arrive in Istanbul.

Key takeaways:

- Start visa planning early.
- Track every core document in one place.
- Separate what you have from what you still need.
- Use the 90, 60, and 30 day rhythm.
- Finish with a ready-to-use document pack.

Why Should Visa Planning Start So Early?

Visa planning affects almost every other part of the move. If you leave it late, your housing plan, travel timing, and document prep can all feel harder than they should.

Early planning gives you space. You can read the guidance, take notes, and think through what applies to your move. That matters because visa needs can vary by person and stay type. A rushed approach often leads to confusion. A steady approach keeps things clear.

The goal is not to solve everything in one sitting. The goal is to build understanding first. Once you know the direction, the rest of the process becomes easier to manage.

What does early planning help you avoid?

Early planning helps you avoid scattered tasks. It also helps you avoid duplicate effort. When your visa notes, document list, and backup copies all live in different places, you spend extra time just trying to find what you already know.

A better system starts with one working list. On that list, you keep your visa notes, your required papers, and your open questions together. That way, you are not rebuilding the same plan again and again.

What should you focus on first?

Start with the basics:

- What visa guidance applies to you
- Which documents you already have
- Which documents still need attention
- Whether your passport is ready
- Where your backup copies will live

Those five questions create a clean starting point. They also keep you from drifting into side tasks before the main ones are done.

What Should You Do at 90 Days Before Arrival?

Ninety days before arrival is your planning stage. This is the best time to understand the visa process and lay out your document system.

You do not need to finish everything yet. You need a clear map. That map should show what is missing, what is ready, and what needs to be checked again later.

1. Review the visa guidance that applies to your move

Start by reading the visa information connected to your situation. Take notes as you go. Keep the notes short and practical. Focus on the main requirements, timing, and any documents that may be needed.

Do not treat this as passive reading. Turn it into action. Write down what the guidance means for your own timeline. If something is unclear, mark it for follow-up.

2. Check your passport status

Your passport should be one of the first things you verify. Look at it early. Confirm that it is in hand and easy to access.

If you keep important travel documents in storage, move them to one place now. You want no surprises later. A missing passport or a misplaced copy can slow down the rest of your plan.

3. Create your document inventory

A document inventory is simple. It is a list of what you already have and what you still need. Use two columns.

- **Have**
- **Still need**

That format works because it is easy to scan. It also makes gaps obvious. If you know what is missing, you can fix it early.

4. Set up your storage system

Choose where your documents will live. You can use a digital folder, a physical folder, or both. The main point is consistency.

Keep originals in one place. Keep copies in another. If you prefer paper, use labels. If you prefer digital, use clear file names. A strong storage system reduces stress when you need something fast.

5. Make backup copies

Backup copies matter. They give you another way to access your documents if you need them. Keep them separate from the originals.

This step is easy to skip. It should not be skipped. A second copy set gives you more control and helps protect your timeline.

90-day visa and document checklist

- Review visa guidance
- Check passport status
- Make a list of required documents
- Build a Have and Still need inventory
- Choose your storage system

How Do You Organize Core Documents Without Losing Track?

A document system only works if you can trust it. That means everything needs a clear home. If one paper goes one place and another paper goes somewhere else, the system becomes harder to use.

The best setup is simple and repeatable. You want a place for originals, a place for copies, and a list that shows what is still missing. That is enough for most planning needs.

What belongs in your core document set?

Your core document set should hold the most important items connected to your move. Keep the set focused. Do not overload it.

A good core document system usually includes:

- Travel documents
- Identity records
- Visa-related papers
- Backup copies
- Notes about where each item is stored

If you are not sure whether a specific item belongs in the set, ask one question: will I need this to stay organized before or during arrival? If the answer is yes, add it.

How do you keep documents easy to find?

Use a naming and labeling system that makes sense immediately. Keep folder names short. Keep notes plain. Avoid mixing categories together.

For example, if you use digital folders, separate them by purpose. If you use paper folders, put one label on each section. That way, you do not have to guess where something belongs.

A search-friendly system saves time. It also lowers stress when you are close to departure. You want quick answers, not a scavenger hunt.

What to do if your papers are scattered

If your papers are already scattered, pause and gather them first. Do not try to improve the system while the documents are still spread out. First collect. Then sort. Then label.

This sequence matters. If you try to organize before gathering, the job becomes harder. Once everything is in one place, the rest gets easier.

Helpful document management habits

- Use one master list
- Keep originals and copies separate
- Store digital files in one folder set
- Label each item clearly
- Review the list weekly

These habits are basic, but they work. They make the move easier to manage.

What Should You Do at 60 Days Before Arrival?

Sixty days before arrival is the collecting stage. You should already understand your visa path. Now the work is about filling gaps and organizing what you have.

This is where many customers make real progress. Not because the tasks get bigger, but because the direction is already set. The earlier planning pays off here.

1. Gather the documents you already have

Bring all available papers into one place. Then match them against your master list. Mark each one as ready, missing, or still pending.

This step gives you a more honest view of your progress. Sometimes people think they are further along than they are. A clear list removes the guesswork.

2. Sort the missing items

If something is missing, note it clearly. Do not leave it floating in your head. Put it next to the item it belongs to.

That small move helps a lot. It turns vague worry into a concrete task. You can then address each gap one by one.

3. Organize copies and backups

At this stage, your backup copies should already exist. Now you make sure they are filed properly. Check that the copies are readable and easy to reach.

A backup that is hard to find does not help much. The value comes from access. Keep the copies in a second place so they are not tied to one location.

4. Recheck the visa timeline

Go back to your visa notes. Review the timing again. Confirm that your current plan still makes sense.

This is a good checkpoint. It gives you a chance to catch issues before the final month. Small corrections now are easier than big fixes later.

5. Keep a running questions list

Do not rely on memory. Keep a short list of any open questions. If something still feels unclear, write it down.

That list helps you stay focused. It also tells you what needs another review before departure.

60-day visa and document checklist

- Gather existing documents
 - Match items against your list
 - Mark missing papers clearly
 - Organize backup copies
 - Recheck the visa timeline
 - Keep an open questions list
-

What Should You Confirm at 30 Days Before Arrival?

Thirty days before arrival is the readiness stage. At this point, your focus changes from planning to confirmation.

You are not trying to redesign your process. You are checking whether the system is ready to travel with you. That means documents, copies, and visa-related notes all need one final review.

1. Confirm your document pack

Your document pack should be complete and easy to access. Check it one more time. Make sure the items you expect are actually there.

If something is still open, deal with it now. This is the month for final action, not delay.

2. Review your passport and copies

Look at your passport again. Check your copies too. You want both the originals and backups ready before departure.

This is a simple step. It matters because it catches small issues early. A final review can save time later.

3. Make documents easy to reach

Put your key papers where you can reach them quickly. If you use digital files, make sure the right folder is easy to open. If you use paper, make sure the folder is packed and labeled.

This is especially useful for travel day. You want quick access, not extra searching.

4. Confirm that visa notes are current

Review your visa notes one last time. Make sure the information you saved still matches your plan. If you need a final reminder, keep it in the same folder as your documents.

That keeps your process tidy. It also helps you feel ready instead of scattered.

30-day visa and document checklist

- Confirm the document pack
 - Review passport status
 - Check backup copies
 - Make documents easy to reach
 - Revisit visa notes
 - Resolve any open items
-

How Does a Simple Tracking System Help?

A simple tracking system removes friction. It turns a large process into visible steps. That matters when you are moving toward a specific departure date.

People often think they need a complex setup. They usually do not. A short checklist with clear status markers works well. It keeps the process honest and easy to update.

What makes a good tracker?

A good tracker should be fast to read. It should show three things:

- What is done
- What is missing
- What still needs review

That is enough. If your tracker becomes crowded, it becomes harder to use. The goal is clarity, not decoration.

Why weekly review matters

Weekly review keeps the plan moving. It gives you a regular moment to update status and clear small issues. That way, nothing sits untouched for too long.

You do not need a long review. Ten minutes can be enough. Check the list. Update the status. Move anything that needs attention.

Simple tracker format

- Task name
- Status
- Notes
- Due stage, such as 90, 60, or 30 days

That format is easy to maintain. It also gives your move a clear rhythm.

What Common Mistakes Should You Avoid?

The biggest mistake is waiting too long. Late planning creates stress. It also makes document gaps harder to fix.

Another mistake is storing everything in too many places. That may feel organized at first. It usually creates confusion later. One master list works better than several scattered ones.

A third mistake is treating the visa process as separate from the rest of the move. It is connected to housing, timing, and arrival readiness. When you plan it early, the full relocation feels more manageable.

Avoid these habits

- Putting off visa review
- Mixing originals and copies
- Keeping several task lists
- Ignoring passport status
- Leaving open questions unresolved

These are simple errors. They are also easy to prevent.

Conclusion: Start the Visa and Document Process Early

Visa planning and document prep do not need to feel overwhelming. They only feel that way when they are left too late.

Start early. Build one master list. Separate your originals from your copies. Review the plan at 90, 60, and 30 days. That structure keeps the process clear and ready for the next stage of your Istanbul move.

Did you do the work?

Write note from Module-2 :-

Module 3: Plan Housing with a Clear Timeline

Research broadly, compare carefully, and confirm without rushing.

Stage	Detailed actions	How to do each step	Completion evidence
90 days	☐ Define stay length, household needs and preferred commute ☐ Separate must-haves from preferences ☐ Set monthly and move-in cost limits ☐ Research several suitable areas ☐ Create one housing comparison tracker	Write a housing brief covering dates, occupants, furnishings, transport access, work or study location and accessibility needs. Set a maximum all-in monthly figure and an upfront-payment ceiling. Create tracker columns for area, rent, deposit, utilities, fees, furnishings, commute, term, contact, source and warning signs.	Housing brief and cost ceiling exist; areas are compared; tracker has a balanced pool of options.
60 days	☐ Verify current availability and full cost ☐ Compare commute, neighborhood fit and contract term ☐ Screen contacts and listings ☐ Request viewing or live video tour ☐ Reduce the list to three to five workable options	Contact each shortlisted provider with the same question set. Ask what is included, what is payable before arrival, cancellation terms, inventory condition and move-in process. Calculate all-in cost rather than rent alone. Do not send payment based only on messages; verify identity, property details and written terms before commitment.	Shortlist shows comparable verified information; weak or unclear options are removed; open questions are recorded.
30 days	☐ Select the preferred property and one backup ☐ Review written terms and payment schedule ☐ Confirm exact dates, address and handover process ☐ Save contact and arrival instructions ☐ Reconcile housing cost with the final budget	Read all terms before accepting and ask for corrections in writing. Confirm the person authorized to hand over access, arrival-hour procedure and what to do if delayed. Save the agreement, receipts, inventory information and contacts together. Update budget lines for deposit, first payment, utilities, fees and transport from arrival point.	Preferred and backup options identified; written terms retained; payments traceable; arrival access instructions complete.

Fillable Template — Module 3: Housing

Stage	User input
90 days	Stay dates / length: _____ Number of occupants: _____ Work or study location: _____ Preferred commute limit: _____ Must-haves: _____ Preferences: _____ Maximum monthly all-in cost: _____ Maximum upfront payment: _____ Areas to research: _____
60 days	Option / area: _____ Rent: _____ Deposit: _____ Utilities / fees: _____ Commute: _____ Contract term: _____ Viewing completed: ☐ Yes ☐ No Provider / contact verified: ☐ Yes ☐ No What is included: _____ Open questions / warning signs: _____ Shortlist rank: _____
30 days	Preferred property: _____ Backup property: _____ Written terms reviewed: ☐ Yes ☐ No Payment schedule: _____ Exact address: _____ Handover contact / time: _____ Delay procedure: _____ Final all-in housing cost: _____ Overall status: ☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red

What Does a Practical Housing Checklist Look Like?

Sta ge	Checklist action	Your entry	Owner / due date	Status / evidence
90 day s	☐ Confirm dates, occupants and commute limit ☐ Separate must-haves from preferences ☐ Set monthly and upfront limits ☐ Select areas to research ☐ Start the housing tracker	Dates / length: _____ Occupants: _____ Work or study location: _____ Commute limit: _____ Must-haves: _____ Preferences: _____ Monthly limit: _____ Upfront limit: _____ Areas: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____ -	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete Evidence: _____
60 day s	☐ Compare all-in cost and contract term ☐ Complete viewing ☐ Verify provider and property details ☐ Record inclusions and warning signs ☐ Rank the shortlist	Option / area: _____ Rent / deposit / fees: _____ Commute / term: _____ Viewing: ☐ Yes ☐ No Verified: ☐ Yes ☐ No Included: _____ Warnings: _____ Rank: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____ -	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red Evidence: _____
30 day s	☐ Select preferred and backup properties ☐ Review written terms and payment schedule	Preferred: _____ Backup: _____ Terms reviewed: ☐ Yes ☐ No Payment schedule: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____ -	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red Evidence: _____

	☐ Confirm address, handover and delay process ☐ Reconcile the final housing cost	Address: _____ Handover: _____ Delay procedure: _____ Final cost: _____		
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Introduction:

Housing can shape your entire Istanbul move. A late decision can raise stress fast. A rushed choice can affect your budget, your timing, and your first weeks after arrival.

A clear housing timeline gives you room to compare options before the pressure builds.

This guide expands Module 3 of the relocation checklist. It shows how to plan housing at 90, 60, and 30 days before arrival. You will see what to focus on at each stage, how to organize your shortlist, and how to keep the process practical.

Key takeaways:

- Start housing research early.
- Use one shortlist, not many scattered notes.
- Match housing choices to your budget.
- Narrow options at 60 days.
- Confirm the final plan at 30 days.

Why Does Housing Deserve Its Own Timeline?

Housing is not just one task on a moving list. It affects other parts of the move. Your budget changes with it. Your arrival setup changes with it. Your planning calendar changes with it.

That is why housing needs structure. A timeline helps you move from broad research to final choice without rushing. You do not need to solve everything on day one. You need a sequence that gives each decision enough space.

What makes housing planning different from other relocation tasks?

Housing often takes longer than expected. You may compare several options before you settle on one. You may also need to balance location, timing, and cost at the same time. That can get messy if you do not organize early.

A housing plan works best when it stays simple. Start with a clear need. Then narrow the field. Then confirm the final choice. Each step should support the next one.

What should your housing goal be?

Your housing goal is not to find every option. It is to find the right fit for your stay. That means thinking about how long you will be in Istanbul, what kind of stay you need, and how much room you have in your budget.

A good goal keeps the search focused. It stops the process from turning into endless browsing.

What Should You Do at 90 Days Before Arrival?

Ninety days before arrival is the research stage. This is where you start broad. You are not choosing yet. You are learning what is available and what matters most to you.

At this stage, your main task is to define the kind of housing you need. If you are planning a long stay, your approach may differ from a shorter visit. Either way, the goal is to create a clear starting point.

What belongs in the 90 day housing phase?

Use this time to:

- Review housing guidance
- Think about your stay length
- Note your housing priorities
- Start collecting options
- Track any questions you still need to answer

That list should feel open, not final. You are building awareness first.

How do you define the kind of housing you need?

Start by asking a few basic questions:

- How long do I expect to stay?
- What kind of housing supports that stay?
- What location factors matter to me?
- What budget range feels realistic?

Write down your answers. Keep them short. You do not need a long essay. You need a clear reference point.

How should you organize early research?

Early research works best when you keep notes in one place. A single sheet or document makes comparison easier later. Add one line per option or one line per idea. Keep the columns simple.

A useful early template includes:

- Housing option or area
- Stay length fit
- Budget fit
- Notes
- Status

This makes it easier to review the shortlist later.

Why not finalize too early?

Early finalization can backfire. You may miss a better fit. You may also commit before you understand your budget fully. A 90 day stage should stay flexible.

That flexibility helps you compare with a clear head. It also makes the next stages more productive.

How Do You Narrow Housing at 60 Days?

Sixty days before arrival is the comparison stage. This is when your early research becomes a shortlist. You should now have enough notes to start narrowing the field.

This stage is about focus. You do not need dozens of options. You need a few workable ones.

What should you compare at this stage?

Focus on the basics:

- Budget fit
- Stay length fit
- Timing fit
- General location notes
- Any practical details you already know

These are the kinds of details that help a customer move from interest to decision. Keep the comparison direct.

How do you build a useful shortlist?

A shortlist should be small enough to manage. If you keep too many choices, the process stays messy. If you keep too few, you may miss a stronger option. A balanced shortlist gives you room to compare without losing control.

A simple shortlist process looks like this:

1. Review your early research.
2. Remove options that no longer fit.
3. Keep the strongest remaining choices.
4. Add notes beside each one.
5. Recheck your budget against the list.

That process keeps the decision practical.

What details should you record?

Your notes should answer the questions you will need later. For example:

- Why is this option still on the list?
- Does it fit the move budget?
- Does it match the stay length?
- What still needs confirmation?

These notes help you avoid revisiting the same question over and over. They also make the final stage smoother.

What if the shortlist still feels too large?

Cut it down again. A shortlist is only useful if you can work with it. If one option is clearly weaker, remove it. If another option does not fit your budget, set it aside.

The point is not to keep everything. The point is to keep what still makes sense.

How Do You Finalize Housing at 30 Days?

Thirty days before arrival is the readiness stage. You should now be close to your final decision. At this point, the work shifts from comparison to confirmation.

This is the time to settle the main housing choice and keep the details in one place. That way, your arrival plan and your housing plan stay aligned.

What should happen in the final month?

Use the last 30 days to:

- Confirm your preferred housing option
- Review any remaining questions
- Keep contact notes ready
- Check the move budget one more time
- Make sure your arrival setup matches your housing plan

This stage should feel calmer than the earlier stages. The main decisions should already be clear.

Why does budget still matter here?

Budget still matters because housing and spending remain linked. A final housing choice should still fit the broader move plan. If it does not, you may need one more adjustment.

This does not mean changing everything. It means checking whether the choice still works in practice.

What should your final housing notes include?

Keep the notes simple and accessible. Include:

- The chosen housing option
- Any contact details you may need
- Timing notes
- Arrival-related reminders
- Any remaining open items

That way, you do not have to search through old messages when time is tight.

What if you are still undecided at 30 days?

If you are still undecided, return to your shortlist. Compare the options again. Focus on the basics. Budget fit, timing fit, and stay length fit should guide the decision.

Avoid creating a brand-new search. Use the work you already completed. A focused review is usually better than starting over.

How Can You Keep the Housing Process Simple?

Housing gets harder when the process becomes too scattered. The simplest way to stay organized is to use one system from start to finish.

You do not need separate notes for every thought. You need one place where the decision lives.

What does a simple housing system look like?

A simple system can include:

- One housing checklist
- One shortlist
- One budget note
- One place for contact details
- One final confirmation note

That is enough for most planning. It keeps the process visible without overcomplicating it.

How often should you review housing notes?

Review them weekly. That rhythm helps you spot changes early. It also keeps your plan active instead of stale.

A short weekly review can answer three questions:

- What is done?
- What is still open?
- What changed since last week?

Those questions keep the housing process moving.

Why does clarity matter so much here?

Clear housing notes save time. They reduce repeat work. They also make it easier to connect your housing plan to other relocation tasks.

A clear plan makes the whole move feel more manageable. That is the real value of using a timeline.

What Does a Practical Housing Checklist Look Like?

A checklist helps readers turn advice into action. Use this one as a working guide for your Istanbul move.

90 days before arrival

- Review housing guidance
- Define your housing need
- Note your stay length
- Start collecting options
- Write down budget limits
- Create a simple housing tracker

60 days before arrival

- Narrow your list
- Compare options against budget
- Remove weak choices
- Add notes beside each option
- Keep a shortlist

- Recheck stay length fit

30 days before arrival

- Confirm the preferred option
- Review contact details
- Check timing against arrival
- Update final housing notes
- Make sure the plan still fits your budget
- Keep everything in one place

This checklist works because it separates research, comparison, and confirmation. That structure makes the process easier to manage.

Conclusion: Plan Housing Early, Then Narrow with Purpose

Housing is one of the most important parts of a move to Istanbul. A clear timeline helps you make better choices and reduces the pressure of last-minute decisions. Start early. Keep your notes organized. Narrow your list at 60 days. Confirm the final choice at 30 days.

If you treat housing as a process instead of a rush, the move feels much easier. You stay in control. You also create more space for the rest of your relocation plan.

Module 4: Build the Move and Stay Budget

Sta ge	Detailed actions	How to do each step	Completion evidence
90 day s	☐ List one-time move costs ☐ Estimate recurring monthly costs ☐ Separate essential, flexible and optional spending ☐ Add contingency and exchange-rate allowance ☐ Build low, expected and high scenarios	Create a budget with category, currency, estimated amount, confirmed amount, due date and payment status. Include travel, baggage, documents, housing deposit, rent, utilities, local transport, food, communications, insurance and setup purchases. Use ranges where uncertain and keep contingency separate rather than hiding it inside other lines.	First budget covers the complete move and at least the first month; assumptions and unknowns are visible.
60 day s	☐ Replace estimates with researched or quoted amounts	Update figures using recent quotes and written terms. Compare total	Most major costs are confirmed; cash-flow dates are known;

	☐ Test each housing option against available funds ☐ Plan currency conversion and payment access ☐ Set spending caps by category ☐ Identify savings or timing adjustments	accessible funds with deposits, travel, first-month needs and emergency reserve. Check card use, account access and transaction limits before departure. If the plan exceeds resources, adjust the largest drivers first rather than cutting essential compliance or safety items.	planned spend does not consume the emergency reserve.
30 days	☐ Confirm all booked, paid and payable amounts ☐ Reserve first-month living funds and emergency funds separately ☐ Prepare more than one accessible payment method ☐ Record exchange assumptions ☐ Start an actual-versus-budget log	Reconcile confirmations and bank records against the budget. Label money by purpose so housing and emergency funds are not accidentally spent. Test payment methods and keep provider contact information available. Record actual spending from departure onward and review variances weekly after arrival.	Final budget reconciles to available funds; due payments are scheduled; emergency reserve is protected; tracking sheet is ready.

Fillable Template — Module 4: Relocation Budget

Stage	User input
90 days	Available relocation funds: _____ One-time cost estimate: _____ Monthly recurring estimate: _____ Essential spending: _____ Flexible spending: _____ Optional spending: _____ Contingency amount / percentage: _____ Low / expected / high total: _____ / _____ / _____ _____
60 days	Confirmed major costs: _____ Housing option tested: _____ Accessible funds after deposits and travel: _____

	<u>Emergency reserve:</u> _____ <u>Currency conversion plan:</u> _____ <u>Card / account limits checked:</u> ☐ Yes ☐ No <u>Spending caps by category:</u> _____ <u>Adjustment required:</u> _____
30 days	<u>Total paid:</u> _____ <u>Total payable:</u> _____ <u>First-month living fund:</u> _____ <u>Protected emergency fund:</u> _____ <u>Primary payment method:</u> _____ <u>Backup:</u> _____ <u>Exchange assumption:</u> _____ <u>Actual-versus-budget log location:</u> _____ <u>Next review date:</u> _____ <u>Overall status:</u> ☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red

What Does a Practical Relocation Budget Checklist Look Like?

Stage	Checklist action	Your entry	Owner / due date	Status / evidence
90 days	☐ Record available funds ☐ Estimate one-time and recurring costs ☐ Classify essential, flexible and optional spending ☐ Add contingency ☐ Calculate low,	<u>Funds:</u> _____ <u>One-time estimate:</u> _____ <u>Monthly estimate:</u> _____ <u>Essential:</u> _____ <u>Flexible:</u> _____ <u>Optional:</u> _____ <u>Contingency:</u> _____ <u>Low / expected /</u>	<u>Owner:</u> _____ <u>Due:</u> _____	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete <u>Evidence:</u> _____ -

	expected and high totals	high: _____		
60 days	☐ Replace estimates with confirmed figures ☐ Test the housing option ☐ Protect the emergency reserve ☐ Confirm conversion and payment access ☐ Set category caps and adjustments	Confirmed costs: _____ Housing tested: _____ Funds after travel / deposit: _____ Emergency reserve: _____ Conversion plan: _____ Limits checked: ☐ Yes ☐ No Caps / adjustment: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____ —	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red Evidence: _____ —
30 days	☐ Reconcile paid and payable amounts ☐ Separate first-month and emergency funds ☐ Confirm primary and backup payment methods ☐ Record the exchange assumption ☐ Start actual-versus-budget tracking	Paid / payable: _____ First-month fund: _____ Emergency fund: _____ Primary / backup payment: _____ Exchange assumption: _____ Tracker location / review: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____ —	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red Evidence: _____ —

Introduction:

Moving to Istanbul brings a lot of decisions. Housing changes the monthly picture. Travel costs hit first. Arrival spending can add pressure fast. Without a budget, even a well-planned move can feel messy.

A simple budget gives you control. It helps you compare choices before you commit. It also keeps your relocation plan connected to

the real cost of living, not guesswork. This guide shows how to build a practical budget for the move and the stay, using a clear timeline and simple categories.

Key takeaways:

- Build the budget before final decisions.
- Separate move costs from stay costs.
- Use one budget for planning and review.
- Keep housing, travel, and arrival costs visible.
- Recheck the budget as your plan changes.

Why Does Budgeting Come Before Finalizing the Move?

Budgeting should sit near the start of the process. It shapes nearly every other choice. Housing, timing, and arrival setup all depend on what the move can support.

A budget also keeps your plan realistic. It shows whether your preferred housing fits your expected spend. It helps you see where you may need to adjust. That matters because a move is easier when your choices support each other.

A lot of customers think of budget as the last step. It is not. It is a decision tool. Use it early, then update it as you learn more.

What does a strong budget help you decide?

A strong budget can help you decide:

- How much to set aside for travel
- What housing range fits your plan
- How much room you have for arrival needs
- Whether your long-stay plan feels realistic
- What needs a closer review before departure

That makes budgeting more than a spreadsheet. It becomes part of the move strategy.

What Costs Should You Include in an Istanbul Move Budget?

A move budget should cover both the move itself and the stay that follows. Keep the categories simple. If you get too detailed too early, the budget becomes harder to use.

1. Travel costs

Start with the cost of getting to Istanbul. This is the first major spend in the move. Add the travel items you expect to pay for before arrival.

2. Housing costs

Housing is one of the most important parts of the budget. It affects your monthly spending and your first few weeks after arrival. Use your housing research to estimate what fits your plan.

3. Arrival costs

Arrival costs cover the practical expenses that show up right away. These may include setup-related spending during the first days or weeks.

4. Daily living costs

Once you arrive, daily living costs become part of the budget picture. These are the ongoing expenses connected to your stay in Istanbul.

5. Document and relocation costs

Some relocation costs connect to paperwork and planning. Keep them visible. Even small items matter when you are trying to stay organized.

A simple budget is easier to maintain when these categories sit in the same place.

How Do You Use Cost of Living Information in the Budget?

Cost of living information gives your budget context. It helps you understand how far your money may go during a long stay in Istanbul.

That matters because a move budget should not stop at arrival. It should show the longer picture too. If your stay is extended, your budget needs to reflect that reality.

Use cost of living information to pressure-test your monthly plan. Compare your expected spending with the housing and lifestyle choices you are considering. If the numbers feel too tight, adjust the plan before you commit.

How should you think about monthly spending?

Monthly spending should be clear, not vague. Put your expected costs into categories. Then review whether the total still feels comfortable.

A useful budget asks one simple question: does this plan support the life I want in Istanbul?

If the answer is no, make changes early. It is easier to adjust a number than to fix a move that no longer fits.

How Do You Build the Budget Step by Step?

A budget works best when it moves from broad to specific. Start with rough categories. Then add detail as the plan becomes clearer.

Step 1: List the main cost groups

Write down the major groups first:

- Travel
- Housing
- Arrival setup
- Daily living
- Documents and relocation tasks

That gives you the structure. Once that structure is in place, the budget becomes easier to fill in.

Step 2: Add estimated amounts

Next, add the amounts you expect to spend. If a number is not known yet, leave a note beside it. Do not force precision too early. The goal is a useful draft.

Step 3: Check the total against your plan

Once the categories are visible, look at the total. Does the move still feel workable? Does the housing choice fit the budget you have set? Do the daily costs seem realistic for the stay you want?

This is where the budget starts helping with decisions. It moves from recordkeeping into planning.

Step 4: Leave room for review

A budget should not stay frozen. Review it as your move becomes clearer. Update it when housing changes. Update it when travel details change. Update it when you learn more about your stay.

That keeps the budget aligned with the move, not behind it.

A simple budget review rhythm

1. Draft the first budget early.
2. Review it at 60 days.
3. Recheck it at 30 days.

4. Confirm the final version before departure.

That rhythm keeps the budget active and useful.

How Does Housing Affect the Budget?

Housing is one of the biggest budget drivers. It can shift the whole plan. That is why housing and budget should be reviewed together.

If your housing choice changes, your monthly spending may change too. A higher housing cost can reduce room for other expenses. A more modest choice may give you more flexibility. Either way, the budget should show the tradeoff clearly.

What should you compare?

Compare housing by asking:

- Does it fit the budget?
- Does it fit the stay length?
- Does it fit the arrival timing?

These questions keep the decision grounded. They also stop the budget from becoming separate from the move itself.

What if the housing choice feels too expensive?

If the housing choice stretches your budget, pause and review. You may need to adjust location, duration, or overall plan. A budget that feels too tight can create stress later.

The goal is not to pick the cheapest option. The goal is to choose a plan that works for the move and the stay.

How Should You Adjust the Budget at 90, 60, and 30 Days?

A relocation budget becomes stronger when it changes with the timeline. The 90, 60, and 30 day stages help you keep it current.

90 days before arrival

At 90 days, your budget is a planning draft. Use broad categories. Keep the numbers flexible. The main goal is to understand the scale of the move.

60 days before arrival

At 60 days, the budget should become more grounded. You should know more about housing and travel. Update the amounts you can now estimate more clearly.

30 days before arrival

At 30 days, the budget should feel close to final. You are not starting over. You are checking what still needs attention before departure.

What should each stage focus on?

- **90 days:** Draft the first version
- **60 days:** Tighten the estimates
- **30 days:** Confirm the final version

That keeps the budgeting process simple and orderly.

What Should a Practical Move Budget Include?

A practical budget needs a clear structure. It should show the key expenses without becoming overloaded.

Budget categories to track

- Travel costs
- Housing costs
- Arrival costs
- Daily living costs
- Document and relocation costs

Budget tracking habits

- Keep one master budget
- Update it regularly
- Note what is estimated
- Note what is confirmed
- Review it before each major decision

These habits help you stay in control. They also make it easier to see where the move stands.

How Do You Keep the Budget Useful After You Arrive?

The budget should not end on arrival day. Your first days in Istanbul still matter. You may have spending that does not fit neatly into the pre-move stage.

Keep a simple version of the budget open after you arrive. Use it to monitor the stay and compare expected costs with actual spending. That is useful for long-stay planning, especially when you want to stay organized.

You do not need a complex system. You need a clear one. The same categories that helped before arrival can still help after arrival.

Conclusion: Start with the Budget, Then Build the Move

A good Istanbul move budget does more than list expenses. It shapes the move itself. It helps you compare housing, track arrival costs, and plan for the stay with more confidence.

Start early. Keep the categories simple. Review the numbers at 90, 60, and 30 days. Then confirm the final version before departure. That process makes the move easier to manage.

Module 5: Arrival Setup and Final Checks

Sta ge	Detailed actions	How to do each step	Completion evidence
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90 days	☐ Create a digital and physical arrival folder ☐ Define day-one, first-week and later tasks ☐ List key contacts and emergency details ☐ Draft the arrival route ☐ Identify tasks that depend on housing or documents	Create folder sections for travel, accommodation, documents, contacts, money and first week. Write a simple arrival chain: landing point, border formalities, baggage, connectivity, transport, accommodation access and check-in. Add contact names, country codes, operating hours and backup methods. Mark dependent tasks so they update when bookings change.	Arrival folder structure exists; arrival chain is documented; contacts and dependencies are visible.
60 days	☐ Add confirmed flight or travel details ☐ Add accommodation and transport information ☐ Prepare offline copies and backup access ☐ Draft first 24-hour and first-week schedules ☐ Create a packing inventory by bag	Save confirmations with concise file names. Download essential items for offline use and place a separate copy with a trusted contact if appropriate. Prioritize rest, accommodation access, connectivity, food and immediate official obligations in the first 24 hours. Record where every critical item will be packed.	Usable folder contains current confirmations; first-day plan is realistic; packing inventory identifies all critical items.
30 days	☐ Reconfirm travel, housing handover and arrival transport ☐ Finalize the first-week plan ☐ Pack key documents, medication and essentials for easy access ☐ Prepare delay and lost-baggage	Check confirmations directly and update changed times immediately. Put essentials in hand luggage: documents, necessary medication, chargers, one change of clothing and accommodation contacts. Write a	Travel-day pack is ready; confirmations are current; backup steps exist; first week has a prioritized schedule.

	contingencies ☐ Complete the final readiness review	delay message template, keep provider numbers available, and identify what can be replaced locally. Review the full checklist 72 hours before departure.	
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Fillable Template — Module 5: Arrival Setup

Stage	User input
90 days	Arrival date / time: _____ Landing point: _____ Accommodation: _____ Arrival route steps: _____ Key contacts / country codes: _____ Emergency contacts: _____ Day-one priorities: _____ First-week priorities: _____ Tasks dependent on housing / documents: _____
60 days	Travel confirmation stored at: _____ Accommodation confirmation stored at: _____ Arrival transport plan: _____ Offline backup location: _____ Trusted contact holding backup: _____ First 24-hour schedule: _____ First-week schedule: _____ Critical item / bag location: _____
30 days	Travel reconfirmed on: _____ Housing handover reconfirmed with: _____ Arrival transport reconfirmed: ☐ Yes ☐ No Hand-luggage essentials: _____ Delay message / recipients: _____ Lost-baggage action: _____ 72-hour review date: _____ Overall status: ☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red

What Does a Practical Arrival Setup Checklist Look Like?

Stage	Checklist action	Your entry	Owner / due date	Status / evidence
90 days	☐ Record arrival date, landing point and accommodation ☐ Map the arrival route ☐ List key and emergency contacts ☐ Define day-one and first-week priorities ☐ Identify dependent tasks	Arrival date / time: _____ Landing point: _____ Accommodation: _____ Route: _____ Contacts: _____ Emergency contacts: _____ Day-one priorities: _____ First-week priorities: _____ Dependencies: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete Evidence : _____ -
60 days	☐ Store travel and accommodation confirmations ☐ Confirm arrival transport ☐ Prepare offline and trusted-contact backups ☐ Draft first-day and first-week schedules ☐ Record critical items by bag	Travel file: _____ Accommodation file: _____ Transport plan: _____ Offline backup: _____ Trusted contact: _____ 24-hour plan: _____ First-week plan: _____ Critical item / bag: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red Evidence : _____ -
30 days	☐ Reconfirm travel, transport and handover	Travel reconfirmed: _____ Handover contact: _____	Owner: _____	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red

	☐ Pack hand-luggage essentials ☐ Prepare delay and lost-baggage actions ☐ Schedule the 72-hour review	Transport confirmed: ☐ Yes ☐ No Hand luggage: _____ Delay message: _____ Lost-baggage action: _____ Review date: _____ _____	Due: _____ _____	Evidence : _____ _____
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Introduction:

The last month before a move can feel busy fast. Small tasks start piling up. Travel details need checking. Documents need one more look. Housing notes need to stay close at hand. Arrival setup is what keeps the final stage under control.

This guide expands Module 5 of the relocation checklist. It shows how to prepare arrival setup and final checks before you travel to Istanbul. You will see what to organize, what to confirm, and how to keep your first days simpler.

Key takeaways:

- Keep your arrival plan in one place.
- Gather documents before departure.
- Confirm travel and housing details early.
- Prepare a first-week plan.
- Use one final checklist pass before you leave.

Why Does Arrival Setup Matter Before You Travel?

Arrival setup turns planning into something practical. It connects your earlier work to the first days in Istanbul. Without it, the move can feel scattered. With it, you know where your key details live and what needs attention first.

This stage matters because you do not want to arrive and start solving everything from zero. Your travel, housing, and documents

should already be ready. That way, you can focus on getting settled instead of searching for information.

What should arrival setup help you avoid?

Arrival setup helps you avoid last-minute confusion. It also reduces duplicate checking. If your housing notes, travel details, and key documents are already organized, you do not need to ask the same questions again and again.

A good arrival plan keeps the final week clear. It also creates a smoother start to the move.

What belongs in this stage?

This stage should cover:

- Key documents
- Travel details
- Housing contact notes
- First-week planning
- Final checklist review

Keep that list simple. The purpose is readiness, not complexity.

What Should Be in Your Arrival Folder?

An arrival folder gives your move a single point of reference. It can be digital, physical, or both. The main point is access. You want the items you may need quickly in one easy place.

Do not spread these details across different apps and notes. One folder is easier to trust. It also saves time when you are close to departure.

What to include in the folder

Your arrival folder should include:

- Travel details
- Housing contact notes
- Key documents
- First-week reminders

- Final task list

That set gives you a clean starting point for travel day and the days after.

How do you keep the folder easy to use?

Use clear labels. Keep file names short. Put the most important items first. If you use paper, keep the folder thin and organized. If you use digital files, make sure the right items open quickly.

A folder is useful only if you can reach what you need fast. That is the standard to keep in mind.

Why do backups matter here?

Backups matter because travel can be unpredictable. Keeping another copy of important details gives you more confidence. It also protects you if one version becomes hard to reach.

This does not need to be complicated. Just keep a second copy of the items you may rely on most.

What Should You Check 30 Days Before Departure?

The final month is the readiness stage. You are not making major new decisions. You are confirming the ones you have already made.

This is the time to review the full setup and catch missing pieces before travel day gets close.

1. Review your documents

Check your documents again. Make sure the important ones are still in the right place. Confirm that your copies are organized and easy to find.

You do not need to rebuild the system. You only need to verify it.

2. Confirm travel details

Look at your travel information and make sure it is current. Keep your notes simple and accessible. If something has changed, update it right away.

Travel details should not sit in a half-finished state during the final weeks. They need one clear home in your arrival folder.

3. Recheck housing notes

Housing and arrival setup should align. Review your housing contact notes. Make sure you know where they are and what they contain.

If your housing plan has changed, update the notes now. That keeps the move from feeling disconnected.

4. Prepare your first-week plan

Your first week deserves its own note. You do not need a long list. You need a practical one.

Think about:

- What you want close at hand
- What can wait until later
- Which details may matter on arrival
- What you want easy to find during the first few days

A short first-week note can make the transition much smoother.

30-day arrival checklist

- Review documents
 - Confirm travel details
 - Recheck housing notes
 - Add first-week planning notes
 - Refresh backup copies
 - Do one final status review
-

How Do You Build a First-Week Plan That Actually Helps?

A first-week plan should lower stress, not add more. The best plan is short, clear, and useful. It helps you handle the basics while you settle in.

Do not overload this list. You do not need every possibility covered. You need the decisions that matter first.

What should your first-week note include?

Keep it focused on practical reminders:

- Important contacts
- Housing details
- Key document locations
- Any immediate arrival tasks
- Notes you will want to see quickly

These items help you stay oriented. They also reduce the chance that you spend your first days looking for something that should already be ready.

What should you avoid including?

Do not stuff the first-week plan with long research notes. Do not add tasks that can wait. Do not turn it into a second master checklist.

The goal is support. The plan should help you move through the first days with less friction.

Why is simplicity better here?

Simplicity helps because arrival days are already full enough. A short note is faster to read. It is also easier to trust when your attention is split across travel, housing, and new surroundings.

A clear first-week plan gives you confidence. That matters when everything else is still settling.

How Should You Handle the Final Checklist Pass?

The final checklist pass is the last review before departure. It should be short and practical. You are checking for missing items, not creating a new system.

This is the moment to look at the full move one more time and confirm that the pieces are in place.

What should you verify?

Check:

- Documents
- Flight or travel details
- Housing notes
- Arrival folder

- First-week plan
- Any open reminders

That list covers the basics. If something still looks unfinished, handle it before you leave.

What does a good final review feel like?

A good final review feels calm. You know what has been done. You know what still needs attention. You are not guessing.

That feeling comes from the earlier work. A solid checklist gives you a cleaner final week.

How long should the final review take?

It does not need to take long. A short, focused pass is usually enough. The key is consistency. Review the full list. Update what changed. Close out anything that no longer needs attention.

What Should You Pack for Easy Access?

Some items should stay easy to reach during travel. Do not bury them deep in packed bags. Keep them in a place you can get to quickly.

This is one of the simplest ways to reduce stress during arrival. If you know where key items are, you spend less time searching.

What belongs in easy access?

Keep these close:

- Core documents
- Travel details
- Housing contact notes
- First-week reminders
- Any essentials tied to your arrival plan

That set gives you practical reach when you need it most.

Why does placement matter?

Placement matters because travel can move quickly. If an important item is tucked away, it takes longer to find. If it is already organized, you save time and reduce pressure.

That is why arrival setup should end with a clear packing decision.

What Are the Most Common Arrival Mistakes?

The most common mistake is waiting too long to organize. Last-minute sorting often leads to confusion. Another mistake is keeping too many notes in different places. That makes the final stage harder than it needs to be.

A third mistake is skipping the first-week plan. Travel does not end when you arrive. You still need a simple note that helps you settle in.

Mistakes to avoid

- Leaving documents in too many places
- Keeping travel details scattered
- Ignoring housing notes
- Skipping the final checklist pass
- Arriving without a first-week plan

These are easy to avoid if you start early.

Conclusion: Keep Arrival Setup Simple and Ready

Arrival setup works best when it stays organized and easy to use. A single folder, a clear first-week note, and one final checklist pass can make the last stage of the move feel much smoother.

The goal is not perfection. The goal is readiness. If your documents, travel details, housing notes, and first-week plan are all easy to reach, you will arrive with less stress and more control

Module 6: Use the Full Checklist in Order

Sta ge	Detailed actions	How to do each step	Completion evidence
90 day s	☐ Combine all module tasks into one plan ☐ Define the required sequence and milestones ☐ Assign one accountable owner per task ☐ Set status rules and review cadence ☐ Create a risk and decision log	Import or copy every active task into one tracker. Order work from planning to documents, housing, budget and arrival. Use consistent statuses: not started, in progress, blocked, complete and post-arrival. Record each risk with likelihood, impact, mitigation, owner and review date. Record major choices with date and reason.	One plan governs the move; no duplicate task lists; owners, milestones, risks and decisions are visible.
60 day s	☐ Review cross-module dependencies ☐ Prioritize legal, travel and housing blockers ☐ Update the critical path ☐ Resolve	Filter for blocked and overdue tasks. Check whether document timing affects travel, whether housing affects budget and whether bookings affect arrival. Resolve conflicts by keeping the most current	No hidden blocker; critical tasks have owners and recovery actions; users work from the same current

	duplicate or conflicting information ☐ Publish a four-week action view	verified information and archiving old versions. Select the small set of actions that must finish in the next four weeks.	plan.
30 days	☐ Run a full readiness review by module ☐ Create final-week, travel-day and first-week checklists ☐ Confirm backup plans for critical failures ☐ Transfer genuine post-arrival work ☐ Close the pre-departure plan	Review each module using red, amber and green status. Red items need immediate action; amber items need a date and owner; green items need evidence. Test scenarios such as delayed travel, unavailable accommodation or missing baggage. Move only tasks that truly require presence in Türkiye to a separate post-arrival list.	All modules show green or managed amber; critical red items are closed; three operational checklists and a post-arrival list are ready.

Fillable Template — Module 6: Integrated Relocation Control

Stage	User input
90 days	Master plan location: _____ Move milestone dates: _____ Status definitions used: _____ Weekly review owner / schedule: _____ Top risk / likelihood / impact: _____ Risk mitigation / owner / review date: _____ Major decision / date / reason: _____
60 days	Blocked or overdue task: _____ Cross-module dependency: _____ Critical-path action: _____ Conflicting information resolved: _____ Source retained / old version archived: _____ _____ Top actions for next four weeks: _____ Recovery owner / deadline: _____
30	Module 1 status: ☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red

days	Module 2 status: ☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red
	Module 3 status: ☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red
	Module 4 status: ☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red
	Module 5 status: ☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red
	Critical backup plans: _____
	Post-arrival tasks / owners / dates: _____
	Pre-departure plan closed by / date: _____

What Does a Practical Integrated Relocation Checklist Look Like?

Sta ge	Checklist action	Your entry	Owner / due date	Status / evidence
90 day s	☐ Confirm the master-plan location and milestones ☐ Define status rules and review schedule ☐ Record the top risk and mitigation ☐ Maintain the decision log	Plan location: _____ Milestones: _____ Status definitions: _____ Review owner / time: _____ Top risk / likelihood / impact: _____ Mitigation / owner / review date: _____ Decision / date / reason: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____ -	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Complete Evidence: _____

60 days	☐ Resolve blockers and dependencies ☐ Update the critical path ☐ Remove conflicting or outdated information ☐ Publish the next four weeks of actions ☐ Assign recovery actions	Blocked task: _____ Dependency: _____ Critical-path action: _____ Conflict resolved: _____ Current source / archive: _____ Top actions: _____ Recovery action: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____ -	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red Evidence: _____
30 days	☐ Rate Modules 1-5 ☐ Confirm critical backup plans ☐ Transfer true post-arrival tasks ☐ Close the pre-departure plan	Module 1: ☐ G ☐ A ☐ R Module 2: ☐ G ☐ A ☐ R Module 3: ☐ G ☐ A ☐ R Module 4: ☐ G ☐ A ☐ R Module 5: ☐ G ☐ A ☐ R Backups: _____ Post-arrival tasks: _____ Closed by / date: _____	Owner: _____ Due: _____ -	☐ Green ☐ Amber ☐ Red Evidence: _____

Introduction:

Relocation checklists fail when they are out of order. A customer starts with packing, then jumps to housing, then returns to visa questions. The move gets noisy. The plan gets harder to trust.

A better approach uses sequence. The right order keeps your Istanbul move calm and practical. It helps you work through visas, housing, budgeting, and arrival setup without losing track of what comes first.

Key takeaways:

- Follow one checklist in sequence.

- Use 90, 60, and 30 day stages.
 - Group tasks by purpose, not by mood.
 - Review the list every week.
 - Finish with a ready arrival plan.
-

Why Does Order Matter in an Istanbul Move?

Order matters because relocation tasks depend on one another. Visa planning affects timing. Housing affects budget. Budget affects what choices still make sense. Arrival setup depends on all three.

When tasks are out of order, you spend energy fixing avoidable gaps. You may collect details that are not useful yet. You may also miss something that should have been handled earlier. A structured order reduces that risk.

A full checklist works best when it matches the real sequence of the move. That does not mean every task sits in one line forever. It means the tasks appear in a sensible path from early planning to final checks.

What goes wrong when the order is unclear?

Without clear order, people often:

- Start too late on visa review
- Research housing before defining the budget
- Leave document checks until the last month
- Forget arrival setup until travel week
- Duplicate work across several lists

Those problems create pressure. They also make the move feel bigger than it needs to feel.

What does a good order give you?

A good order gives you:

- A clearer timeline
- Fewer repeated decisions
- A better sense of progress
- Less stress at the end

- More confidence in the plan

That is the real value of sequence. It turns a long move into a manageable process.

What Is the Right Sequence for the Full Checklist?

A useful Istanbul relocation checklist usually moves through five stages. Each stage sets up the next one.

Stage 1: Map the move

Start by understanding the move itself. Define the time frame. Identify the main categories. Create one master checklist.

This stage gives your plan shape. You do not need every answer. You need a place to hold the answers as they come.

Stage 2: Handle visas and core documents

Next, focus on visa guidance and documents. This should happen early because it affects your timing and your readiness.

Keep your passport status, paper copies, and open document items in one place. If you wait too long, the rest of the plan becomes harder to manage.

Stage 3: Plan housing with a clear timeline

After visas and documents, turn to housing. Housing affects where you spend, how you arrive, and what kind of stay you can support.

Begin broad at 90 days. Narrow at 60 days. Confirm at 30 days. That rhythm keeps the search organized.

Stage 4: Build the move and stay budget

Once housing is taking shape, build the budget. Include travel, housing, arrival costs, daily living costs, and document-related spending.

Budgeting at this point works well because you now know more about the move. The numbers become more useful when they reflect real choices.

Stage 5: Prepare arrival setup and final checks

The last stage is arrival preparation. Use this phase to confirm your documents, housing notes, budget, and first-week plan.

This is where everything comes together. The checklist should make arrival feel ready, not rushed.

How Should You Use the 90, 60, and 30 Day Timeline?

The 90, 60, and 30 day structure keeps the checklist practical. It breaks the move into clear phases. That way, you know what to work on now and what can wait.

90 days before arrival

At 90 days, you are building the base. Focus on:

- Mapping the move
- Reviewing visa guidance
- Making a document inventory
- Starting housing research
- Drafting a budget
- Creating a master checklist

This stage is about awareness. It is not about completion. You are setting the frame.

60 days before arrival

At 60 days, your plan should become more focused. Work on:

- Confirming document gaps
- Narrowing housing options
- Updating budget figures
- Keeping notes in one place
- Sorting open questions

This stage should reduce uncertainty. The checklist becomes more specific here.

30 days before arrival

At 30 days, the goal is readiness. Focus on:

- Confirming documents
- Revisiting visa notes

- Finalizing housing details
- Reviewing the budget
- Preparing arrival materials
- Setting the first-week plan

This is the stage where the checklist proves its value. The move should feel organized, not scrambled.

How Do You Keep One Master Checklist Working?

A master checklist works best when it stays simple. It should show the full move in one place. If it gets too scattered, it stops helping.

What should the checklist include?

A useful master checklist should include:

- Task name
- Category
- Due stage
- Status
- Notes

That structure keeps the list readable. It also helps you compare what is done with what still needs attention.

What categories should you use?

Keep the categories aligned with the move:

- Mapping the move
- Visas and documents
- Housing
- Budgeting
- Arrival setup
- Final checks

Those categories hold the process together. They also make weekly review easier.

How do you avoid list overload?

Do not create separate lists for every small task. Put everything in one system. Then sort by category or timeline. That keeps the checklist useful instead of fragmented.

If a task is not important to the move, drop it. If it is important, move it into the correct stage. The master list should be honest, not crowded.

What Should You Focus on in Each Part of the Checklist?

A full checklist becomes easier to use when each part has a clear job.

Mapping the move

This is where you define the structure. You decide how the checklist will work and what needs to fit into it.

Visas and documents

This part protects timing and readiness. It keeps your paperwork in order before the move gets close.

Housing

This part keeps your stay practical. It helps you compare options and narrow choices before arrival.

Budgeting

This part tests your plan against reality. It shows whether the move and the stay still fit your spending shape.

Arrival setup

This part prepares the final stretch. It ensures your first days in Istanbul are easier to manage.

Final checks

This part closes the loop. It confirms that the plan is actually ready to use.

A strong checklist gives each part a job. That prevents overlap and confusion.

How Often Should You Review the Checklist?

A checklist only works if you keep it current. Weekly review is enough for most planning stages.

A simple weekly review routine

1. Open the master checklist.
2. Mark completed items.
3. Move active tasks into this week's focus.
4. Recheck anything that changed.
5. Remove tasks that no longer matter.

This routine takes only a little time. It keeps the move moving.

Why does weekly review matter so much?

Weekly review keeps you honest. It shows whether your plan is actually progressing. It also helps you avoid last-minute surprises.

A checklist that is never updated becomes decoration. A checklist that is reviewed becomes a tool.

What Are the Most Common Checklist Mistakes?

People often make the same mistakes with relocation planning. These mistakes are easy to avoid once you spot them.

Mistake 1: Treating every task as equal

Some tasks matter earlier than others. Visa and documents should not sit at the same level as packing.

Mistake 2: Starting with final details

Final details matter, but not first. Use the timeline to keep them in the right place.

Mistake 3: Splitting the move across too many notes

Too many lists create confusion. One master checklist is usually clearer.

Mistake 4: Ignoring the budget

A checklist without a budget can feel complete while still being unrealistic.

Mistake 5: Skipping final checks

Final checks close the move. Without them, the plan stays unfinished. These mistakes do not need complex fixes. They need better order.

How Do You Turn the Checklist into a Working Plan?

A checklist becomes useful when it guides action. That means you need to move through it in sequence. Start early. Stay consistent. Review it often.

A simple order to follow

1. Map the move.
2. Review visas and documents.
3. Plan housing.
4. Build the budget.
5. Prepare arrival setup.
6. Complete final checks.

That order gives the move a clean path. It also keeps the work manageable.

What should you do if the checklist feels too long?

Break it into stages, not separate systems. Use the 90, 60, and 30 day framework. That keeps the list from feeling overwhelming.

If a task belongs to a later phase, leave it there. Do not pull everything forward at once.

What should you do if you fall behind?

Return to the current stage. Do not restart the whole checklist. Focus on the most immediate tasks and move forward from there.

That is how the checklist stays useful even when plans change.

Conclusion: Use the Checklist in the Right Order

A full Istanbul relocation checklist works best when it follows the move itself. Start with planning. Move to visas and documents. Then housing. Then budgeting. Finish with arrival setup and final checks.

That sequence keeps the process steady. It also gives your move a clear path from first notes to final readiness. If you want a calmer relocation, do not just use a checklist. Use it in order.

Ready to put your plan into action?

Explore MoveToIstanbul's **relocation and long-stay guide for Istanbul, visa guides, housing guides, cost of living guides,** and **concierge service** to support your move from start to finish.

Part II: Istanbul Settling-In and Long-Stay Toolkit

A practical post-arrival extension with action plans, checklists, decision records, and reusable worksheets.

This appendix continues the 90-60-30-day preparation guide into the first 90 days after arrival. Use it as a working companion rather than a book to read once. Complete the sections that apply to your immigration status, household, employment, study, and housing

arrangement, and confirm legal or administrative requirements through current official channels before acting.

7. Your First 24 Hours in Istanbul

The first day should be intentionally light. Your priorities are safe arrival, access to accommodation, communication, food, rest, and confirmation that essential belongings and documents are secure. Avoid scheduling optional appointments immediately after a long journey.

- ☐ Confirm that every traveler and checked bag has arrived.
- ☐ Connect to a trusted network or activate your planned mobile service.
- ☐ Notify your accommodation contact of your arrival.
- ☐ Use the pre-planned transport route and keep a backup option ready.
- ☐ Inspect the accommodation before unpacking fully.
- ☐ Photograph existing property damage and report it in writing.
- ☐ Locate exits, smoke alarms, utility shutoffs, and building information.
- ☐ Buy only immediate essentials for the first evening and morning.
- ☐ Send a safe-arrival message to your designated contact.
- ☐ Set an alarm for any time-sensitive next-day obligation.

First-Day Decision Record

Item	Your entry
Actual arrival time	_____ ____
Accommodation access confirmed by	_____ ____
Primary transport used	_____ ____
Missing or damaged baggage action	_____ ____
Property issue reported	_____ ____
Tomorrow's first priority	_____ ____

8. The First Seven Days: Stabilize Before You Optimize

Your first week is for establishing a reliable base. Complete urgent legal, housing, health, work, or study obligations first. Delay optional purchases and long-term commitments until you have tested the neighborhood, commute, and household routine.

1. **Day 1:** Rest, inspect the property, secure documents, and confirm immediate communication.
2. **Day 2:** Walk the local area and identify groceries, pharmacy, transport stops, cash access, and a backup route home.
3. **Day 3:** Review immigration, residence, employment, or study actions and confirm the next deadline.
4. **Day 4:** Test the commute at the time you normally expect to travel.
5. **Day 5:** Review the first week's spending and compare it with the arrival budget.
6. **Day 6:** Complete basic home setup without overbuying.
7. **Day 7:** Hold a 30-minute review and set priorities for weeks two to four.

Week-One Review Questions

- What must be completed before the next immigration or administrative deadline?
- Is the accommodation safe, functional, and consistent with the written agreement?
- Does the actual commute match the housing decision?
- Which recurring costs are higher or lower than expected?
- Which first-week purchases were essential, and which can wait?
- What information should be added to the arrival folder?
- What is the single most important task for next week?

9. Immigration and Administrative Follow-Through

Entry permission and permission to remain are not always the same. Keep the exact conditions of your nationality, purpose, and length of stay visible. The official migration information indicates that stays beyond the permitted visa or visa-exemption period, or beyond 90 days where applicable, require the appropriate residence authorization. Do not rely on informal advice, old screenshots, or another traveller's experience.

Administrative Control Checklist

- ☐ Record the lawful stay end date shown by your route and entry circumstances.
- ☐ Confirm whether a residence, work, study, family, or other authorization is required.
- ☐ Use the official application channel that applies to your case.
- ☐ Check passport validity against the requested authorization period.
- ☐ Record the application date, appointment date, fee status, and missing-document deadline.
- ☐ Keep the submitted form, payment receipts, appointment evidence, and copies together.
- ☐ Confirm whether address, insurance, financial, translation, or legalization evidence applies.
- ☐ Track the application result only through official channels.
- ☐ Save the relevant migration contact number and provincial office details.
- ☐ Recheck travel restrictions or exit conditions while an application is pending.

Application Tracker

Requirement	Status	Evidence location	Deadline / next action
Stay route confirmed	_____ –	_____	_____
Application submitted	_____ –	_____	_____
Appointment	_____ –	_____	_____
Fees	_____ –	_____	_____
Address evidence	_____ –	_____	_____
Insurance evidence	_____ –	_____	_____
Result / card delivery	_____ –	_____	_____

10. Creating an Administrative Identity and Digital Access Plan

Once eligible, Türkiye's e-Government Gateway can provide access to many public services from one place. The official guidance for non-citizens states that access to electronic services may require visiting a PTT center with the applicable residence documentation and foreigner identification number. Eligibility and required documents can vary, so confirm the current process before visiting.

- ☐ Record your foreigner identification number when officially issued.
- ☐ Confirm when you become eligible for e-Government access.
- ☐ Prepare the identification and residence documents required for access.
- ☐ Use a unique password and protect account recovery information.
- ☐ Review available immigration, address, social security, health, tax, and document services relevant to you.
- ☐ Download only records you need and store sensitive copies securely.
- ☐ Never share verification codes or account credentials with agents or contacts.
- ☐ Keep a log of official submissions and reference numbers.

11. Housing Handover and the First-Month Property Check

A careful handover protects both the tenant and the property owner. Record condition, access items, meter information, included furnishings, and maintenance issues before the details become difficult to prove. Keep communication factual and in writing.

Room-by-Room Inspection

- **Entrance:** keys, locks, door closure, intercom, building access, visible damage.
- **Living area:** windows, curtains, lighting, sockets, furniture condition, heating or cooling controls.
- **Kitchen:** water, drainage, refrigerator, cooker, extractor, cupboards, inventory, signs of leakage.
- **Bathroom:** hot water, taps, drainage, ventilation, seals, toilet operation, moisture or mold.
- **Bedrooms:** windows, storage, furniture, sockets, bedding inventory, external noise.

- **Utilities:** meter readings, account responsibility, shutoff points, internet equipment, service contacts.
- **Safety:** exits, smoke detection where provided, balcony security, heavy furniture stability, emergency assembly information.

Property Issue Log

Date found	Location / issue	Evidence	Reported to	Target resolution
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

12. Utilities, Connectivity, and Household Services

Before opening or transferring any service, check the lease and written handover terms. Clarify which utilities are included, whose name appears on each account, how deposits work, and how final readings will be handled when you leave.

- ☐ Electricity responsibility confirmed.
- ☐ Water responsibility confirmed.
- ☐ Natural gas or heating arrangement confirmed.
- ☐ Building fees and payment schedule confirmed.
- ☐ Internet provider, installation date, equipment, and cancellation terms recorded.
- ☐ Mobile plan coverage tested at home and on the commute.
- ☐ Meter readings photographed at handover.
- ☐ Account numbers and support channels stored securely.
- ☐ Automatic payments reviewed before activation.
- ☐ Move-out closure or transfer process noted for later.

Service Comparison Worksheet

Service	Provider / contact	Setup cost	Recurring cost	Commitment / notes
Mobile	_____	_____	_____	_____

Internet	_____	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____	_____
Electricity	_____	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____	_____
Water	_____	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____	_____
Gas / heating	_____	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____	_____

13. Banking, Payments, and Financial Control

Financial setup should prioritize continuity and visibility. Keep more than one lawful payment method available, understand fees before authorizing transactions, and do not move the emergency reserve into everyday spending.

- ☐ Confirm that home-country cards remain active and travel notices are complete.
- ☐ Record foreign transaction, cash withdrawal, and conversion charges.
- ☐ Set daily and monthly alerts for unusual activity.
- ☐ Keep one payment method physically separate from the primary wallet.
- ☐ Confirm the documents required before applying for a local account.
- ☐ Compare account fees, transfer options, branch access, and support availability.
- ☐ Protect one month of essential spending and the emergency reserve.
- ☐ Reconcile deposits, rent, and utility payments against written receipts.
- ☐ Review digital subscriptions and cancel services no longer needed.
- ☐ Update the actual-versus-budget tracker every week.

Monthly Cash-Flow Worksheet

Category	Budget	Actual	Difference	Action
Housing	_____	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____	_____
Utilities	_____	_____	_____	_____
	_____	_____	_____	_____

	—	—	—	—
Food	— —	— —	— —	— —
Transport	— —	— —	— —	— —
Health / insurance	— —	— —	— —	— —
Communication s	— —	— —	— —	— —
Other	— —	— —	— —	— —

14. Learning Istanbul's Transport System

Istanbul's network includes buses, rail, ferries, and other linked services. Use current official journey planners and service notices because routes, temporary changes, and expected arrival times can vary. Test the commute in both directions and at realistic travel times before making permanent routine decisions.

- ☐ Identify the nearest bus, metro, tram, rail, ferry, or metrobüs options.
- ☐ Compare the fastest route with the simplest route.
- ☐ Save a backup route that uses a different mode where possible.
- ☐ Test the return trip after normal working or study hours.
- ☐ Note the final connection needed to reach home.
- ☐ Review official notices before important journeys.
- ☐ Allow time for transfers, walking, security checks, and traffic variation.
- ☐ Record accessibility needs for each transfer point where relevant.
- ☐ Keep enough payment balance for an unplanned return journey.
- ☐ Reassess the route after two weeks of real use.

Commute Test Record

Route	Departure / day	Door-to-door time	Transfe rs	Cost / notes
Primary outbound	—	—	— —	—
Primary	—	—	—	—

return			-	
Backup outbound	_____	_____	_____ -	_____
Backup return	_____	_____	_____ -	_____

15. Health, Medication, and Insurance Readiness

Prepare health information before it is needed. Keep insurance details, necessary prescriptions, medication names, allergies, and emergency contacts available offline. For urgent emergencies in Türkiye, the Ministry of Health identifies 112 as the emergency call service.

- ☐ Confirm the start and end dates of insurance coverage.
- ☐ Record exclusions, reimbursement steps, and required pre-authorization.
- ☐ Save insurer contact numbers and policy details offline.
- ☐ Carry necessary medication in original packaging where appropriate.
- ☐ Keep a clinician-issued prescription or supporting record when required.
- ☐ Record generic medication names as well as brand names.
- ☐ Identify a nearby pharmacy and a backup option.
- ☐ Identify an appropriate clinic or hospital before a non-urgent need arises.
- ☐ Store allergy, condition, and emergency-contact information accessibly.
- ☐ Review refill timing well before the supply becomes low.

Personal Health Information Card

Field	Your entry
Full name and date of birth	_____ _____
Insurance provider / policy	_____ _____
Allergies	_____ _____
Current medication	_____ _____
Relevant conditions	_____ _____

Emergency contact	_____

Preferred language / assistance	_____

16. Earthquake and Emergency Readiness at Home

Build preparedness into the home setup. AFAD guidance emphasizes securing items that could fall or overturn, keeping exit routes clear, understanding utility shutoffs, and maintaining a household preparedness plan. Review the plan with everyone in the household and update it when the home or occupants change.

- ☐ Identify the safest available areas in each room away from glass and falling objects.
- ☐ Keep exit routes clear and doors accessible.
- ☐ Secure tall furniture and heavy objects appropriately.
- ☐ Avoid storing heavy items above beds or seating areas.
- ☐ Learn how to shut off gas, electricity, and water if authorized and necessary.
- ☐ Record the building's assembly area and management contact.
- ☐ Prepare a practical household emergency supply kit.
- ☐ Keep copies of identity, residence, insurance, and key contacts accessible.
- ☐ Agree on an out-of-area contact and a communication plan.
- ☐ Review the plan periodically and after moving furniture.

Household Emergency Plan

Plan item	Your entry
Building exit route	_____

Nearest assembly area	_____

Utility shutoff locations	_____

Household meeting point	_____

Out-of-area contact	_____

Emergency kit location	_____
Assistance needed by household members	_____
Next review date	_____

17. Food, Household Shopping, and a Sustainable Routine

Start with a seven-day household plan rather than a large arrival shop. Learn local package sizes, storage limits, market days, delivery conditions, and actual consumption before buying in bulk. Track the first month so routine spending becomes predictable.

First-Week Starter List

- Drinking water plan appropriate to the accommodation.
- Simple breakfast and two or three easy meals.
- Basic cleaning supplies permitted by the property.
- Toiletries and laundry essentials.
- Waste bags and recycling information where provided.
- Only the cookware or utensils genuinely missing.
- A small reserve of familiar shelf-stable food.
- Reusable shopping bags and a written list.

Weekly Household Review

Question	Notes
What ran out too early?	_____
What was overbought?	_____
Which store gave the best overall value?	_____
Which meals worked with the schedule?	_____
What is next week's spending cap?	_____

18. Working or Studying from Istanbul

Separate legal authorization from practical readiness. Confirm with the responsible employer, institution, and official authority which permissions apply. Then build a daily system around communication, attendance, working hours, equipment, data security, and the commute.

- ☐ Written start date and reporting location confirmed.
- ☐ Required authorization and documentation route confirmed.
- ☐ Working or class hours recorded in local time.
- ☐ Primary and backup internet arrangements tested.
- ☐ Equipment, power, adapter, and security needs completed.
- ☐ Commute tested during the expected schedule.
- ☐ Payroll, stipend, invoicing, or fee arrangements clarified.
- ☐ Attendance, leave, and emergency contact procedures recorded.
- ☐ Confidential information is not exposed through shared networks or spaces.
- ☐ First-month review is scheduled with the relevant contact.

19. Communication and Essential Turkish

You do not need fluency to manage everyday life confidently. A small, well-practised set of Turkish phrases can help you greet people, ask simple questions, confirm prices and directions, explain basic needs, and recognize common responses. Focus first on situations you will repeat every week. Keep important addresses and personal details written clearly, and use qualified language support for legal, medical, financial, immigration, or contractual matters where accuracy is critical.

A Practical Four-Step Learning Method

1. **Learn by situation:** group phrases under transport, shopping, housing, work, health, and emergencies instead of memorizing random vocabulary.
2. **Practise aloud:** repeat each phrase slowly until you can say it without reading every word.
3. **Listen for the reply:** learn the likely short answers, numbers, place names, and gestures that may follow your question.
4. **Review after use:** add the words you needed but did not know to a personal phrase list and practise them before the next similar interaction.

Pronunciation and Politeness Basics

- **ç** sounds like “ch” in “chair.”

- **ş** sounds like “sh” in “shop.”
- **c** sounds like “j” in “job.”
- **ğ** is usually soft and often lengthens the surrounding vowel.
- **ı** is an undotted vowel with no exact English equivalent; listen and imitate rather than replacing it with “i.”
- **ö** and **ü** are rounded vowels; careful listening is more useful than forcing an English approximation.
- Use **lütfe**n for “please” and **teşekkür ederim** for “thank you.”
- When addressing an unfamiliar adult or service worker, use complete polite requests rather than single-word commands.

Core Phrases for Everyday Interaction

Purpose	Useful Turkish	Meaning
Greeting	Merhaba	Hello
Thanks	Teşekkür ederim	Thank you
Request	Lütfe	Please
Clarification	Anlamadım	I did not understand
Slower speech	Lütfe	Could you speak slowly, please?
Price	Ne kadar?	How much?
Location	Nerede?	Where?
Help	Yardı	Could you help?
Emergency	Acil durum	Emergency

Greetings and Courteous Conversation

Turkish	Meaning	When to use
Günaydın	Good morning	Morning greeting
İyi günler	Good day	Polite daytime greeting or farewell
İyi akşamlar	Good evening	Evening greeting
Hoşça kalın	Goodbye	Said by the person leaving
Görüşürüz	See you	Informal farewell
Afedersini	Excuse me	Getting attention or apologizing

z		politely
Rica ederim	You are welcome	Reply to thanks
Evet / Hayır	Yes / No	Basic response

Clarifying and Repairing a Conversation

Turkish	Meaning
Türkçe bilmiyorum	I do not speak Turkish
Biraz Türkçe konuşuyorum	I speak a little Turkish
İngilizce konuşuyor musunuz?	Do you speak English?
Tekrar eder misiniz?	Could you repeat that?
Lütfen yazar mısınız?	Could you write it down, please?
Bu ne demek?	What does this mean?
Doğru mu anladım?	Did I understand correctly?
Bir dakika, lütfen	One moment, please

Transport and Directions

Turkish	Meaning
... nasıl giderim?	How do I get to ...?
Bu otobüs ... gidiyor mu?	Does this bus go to ...?
En yakın metro istasyonu nerede?	Where is the nearest metro station?
Hangi durakta inmeliyim?	At which stop should I get off?
Bir sonraki durak hangisi?	What is the next stop?
Bu koltuk boş mu?	Is this seat free?
Burada durur musunuz?	Could you stop here?
Adres bu	This is the address

Shopping, Food, and Payments

Turkish	Meaning
Bu ne kadar?	How much is this?
Kart geçiyor mu?	Do you accept cards?
Nakit ödeyeceğim	I will pay in cash
Fiş alabilir miyim?	May I have a receipt?
Menüye bakabilir miyim?	May I see the menu?
Su, lütfen	Water, please
Hesap, lütfen	The bill, please
Bunu istemiyorum	I do not want this
Başka var mı?	Is there another one?

Housing and Household Services

Turkish	Meaning
Ev sahibine ulaşamıyorum	I cannot reach the landlord
Anahtar çalışmıyor	The key is not working
Sıcak su yok	There is no hot water
Elektrik yok	There is no electricity
İnternet çalışmıyor	The internet is not working
Bir sızıntı var	There is a leak
Ne zaman gelebilirsiniz?	When can you come?
Lütfen mesajla teyit edin	Please confirm by message

Work, Study, and Appointments

Turkish	Meaning
Randevum var	I have an appointment
Adım ...	My name is ...
Saat kaçta?	At what time?
Geç kaldım, özür dilerim	I am late, I am sorry
Bu belgeyi nereye vermeliyim?	Where should I submit this document?
Hangi belge eksik?	Which document is missing?
E-posta ile gönderebilir misiniz?	Could you send it by email?
Yazılı teyit alabilir miyim?	May I have written confirmation?

Health and Emergency Communication

Turkish	Meaning
Yardıma ihtiyacım var	I need help
Ambulans çağırın	Call an ambulance
Adresim ...	My address is ...
Alerjim var	I have an allergy
Bu ilacı kullanıyorum	I use this medication
Doktora ihtiyacım var	I need a doctor
Kayboldum	I am lost
Polise ihtiyacım var	I need the police
İngilizce bilen biri var mı?	Is there someone who speaks English?

Numbers, Dates, and Time

Numbers are essential for prices, addresses, telephone numbers, floors, dates, and appointment times. Start with **bir** (one), **iki** (two), **üç** (three), **dört** (four), **beş** (five), **altı** (six), **yedi** (seven), **sekiz** (eight), **dokuz** (nine), and **on** (ten). Useful time questions include **Saat kaç?** (What time is it?) and **Bugün mü, yarın mı?** (Today or

tomorrow?). When accuracy matters, repeat the number back and ask for written confirmation.

Using Translation Tools Safely and Effectively

- Write short, direct sentences and translate one idea at a time.
- Avoid slang, jokes, abbreviations, and long messages with several requests.
- Show the original and translated text together when clarification may be needed.
- Use camera translation for simple signs or labels, but verify anything involving payment, medicine, safety, or legal obligations.
- Ask the other person to type important names, numbers, addresses, dates, and instructions.
- Save essential phrases and addresses offline before leaving reliable internet coverage.
- Do not use an automatic translation alone to accept a contract, provide informed medical consent, submit an immigration statement, or authorize a major financial transaction.

Communication Etiquette for Daily Life

- Begin with a greeting before asking a question.
- Speak clearly at a normal volume; speaking louder does not improve understanding.
- Use names, addresses, and numbers in writing when pronunciation may cause confusion.
- Allow the other person time to read or reply.
- Confirm the final action: who will do what, by when, and how it will be communicated.
- For service problems, describe the issue factually and keep the written confirmation.
- If you are unsure, say that you did not understand rather than pretending to agree.

Personal Essential Phrase Planner

Situation	Phrase I need	Turkish wording	Practised / notes
Home address	_____ —	_____ —	_____ —
Daily commute	_____ —	_____ —	_____ —
Shopping	_____ —	_____ —	_____ —

Housing problem	_____	_____	_____
	—	—	—
Work / study	_____	_____	_____
	—	—	—
Health	_____	_____	_____
	—	—	—
Emergency	_____	_____	_____
	—	—	—
Other	_____	_____	_____
	—	—	—

A 30-Day Essential Turkish Practice Plan

1. **Week 1:** greetings, thanks, yes and no, numbers, and asking for repetition.
2. **Week 2:** home address, transport questions, shopping, and payments.
3. **Week 3:** housing problems, appointments, documents, work, or study phrases.
4. **Week 4:** health, emergency phrases, full-sentence practice, and review of words collected from real interactions.

Practice for 10 to 15 minutes each day. Use three cycles: read the phrase, say it without looking, and imagine the response you may hear. The goal is not perfect grammar; it is calm, clear communication and the ability to recognize when you need additional help.

20. Building a Reliable Local Support Network

A support network is most useful when each contact has a clear purpose. Keep official, professional, accommodation, work or study, and personal contacts in separate categories. Confirm availability and preferred communication methods before an urgent need occurs.

Contact role	Name / organization	Contact details	When to use
Accommodation	_____	_____	_____
Employer / institution	_____	_____	_____
Migration information	_____	_____	_____
Insurance	_____	_____	_____

Medical	_____	_____	_____
Trusted local contact	_____	_____	_____
Out-of-area contact	_____	_____	_____

21. The 30-Day Settling-In Review

At the end of the first month, compare the plan with real life. Do not judge the move only by the first few days. Use evidence from spending, commute time, housing condition, administrative progress, and routine stability.

Area	Green	Amb er	Red	Next action
Immigration / administration	☐	☐	☐	_____
Housing	☐	☐	☐	_____
Budget	☐	☐	☐	_____
Transport	☐	☐	☐	_____
Health / insurance	☐	☐	☐	_____
Work / study	☐	☐	☐	_____
Emergency readiness	☐	☐	☐	_____

Questions for the 30-Day Review

- Which legal or administrative task has the nearest deadline?
- What housing problem needs written follow-up?
- What category caused the largest budget variance?
- Is the commute sustainable five days per week?
- Are insurance and medication arrangements usable in practice?
- Does the household emergency plan reflect the actual property?
- Which local contact has been most reliable?
- What should change before day 60?

22. The 60-Day Optimization Review

By day 60, most basic systems should work. Shift from setup to optimization. Replace temporary arrangements only when the benefit is clear and the terms are understood.

- ☐ Consolidate duplicate files and archive outdated confirmations.
- ☐ Update the budget using two full months of actual spending.
- ☐ Renegotiate or replace only services that are poor value or unreliable.
- ☐ Confirm all address, residence, work, or study records are consistent.
- ☐ Review the lease and calendar future notice dates.
- ☐ Improve the commute using actual journey data.
- ☐ Restock the emergency kit and update household contacts.
- ☐ Schedule recurring health, administrative, and financial reminders.
- ☐ Remove arrival-only tasks from the active dashboard.
- ☐ Identify one priority for the next 30 days.

23. The 90-Day Long-Stay Readiness Review

The 90-day review closes the relocation phase and opens normal long-stay management. Confirm that every ongoing obligation has an owner, evidence, next date, and secure storage location. Any unresolved red item should be acted on immediately through the appropriate official or professional channel.

1. Review lawful stay and authorization dates.
2. Confirm address and identity records are current where applicable.
3. Check housing notice periods, deposit evidence, and renewal decisions.
4. Review three months of actual spending and reset category limits.
5. Confirm health coverage, medication, and emergency information.
6. Evaluate whether the commute and weekly routine are sustainable.
7. Update the household emergency plan.
8. Archive completed relocation tasks.
9. Create a calendar for renewals, reviews, and future travel.
10. Write a short lessons-learned note for the next move or renewal.

Relocation problems become easier to control when you use the same response pattern every time: protect immediate safety, confirm the facts, preserve evidence, contact the responsible party, set a deadline, and prepare a fallback. Avoid making major payments, signing revised terms, or surrendering original documents while facts remain unclear. For legal, immigration, medical, or contractual problems, use qualified official or professional support rather than relying only on informal advice.

Use the Six-Step Relocation Recovery Method

1. **Stabilize:** address safety, shelter, health, communication, and access to essential money first.
2. **Verify:** identify exactly what happened, what is missing, who is responsible, and which deadline applies.
3. **Document:** save messages, receipts, photographs, names, dates, reference numbers, and copies of submitted material.
4. **Escalate:** contact the correct provider, official authority, insurer, employer, institution, or emergency service.
5. **Set a checkpoint:** record the promised action and the time when you will follow up.
6. **Activate the fallback:** use your backup accommodation, payment method, route, document copy, or local support contact if the original plan cannot be restored promptly.

A critical document is missing, rejected, or inconsistent

First identify whether the problem is loss, expiry, incorrect information, missing translation, missing legalization, unreadable copy, or inconsistency between records. Write down the exact wording used by the receiving office and the deadline for correction. Contact the issuing authority or the official channel responsible for the application, not an unrelated intermediary.

- Check secure digital storage, hand luggage, and the trusted-contact backup.
- Confirm whether an original, certified copy, translation, apostille, legalization, or replacement is required.
- Compare spelling, dates, passport number, and document validity across every related form.
- Ask whether temporary evidence or a later submission is officially accepted.
- Record the staff member or channel, date, reference number, and exact instruction.
- Request replacement documents immediately and obtain proof of the request.

- Do not edit scanned records or submit unverified substitutes.
- If the issue affects immigration, contact YIMER 157 or the relevant official migration office for current guidance.

Housing access fails or the property differs from the agreement

Remain in a safe, public, connected location while resolving access. Contact the authorized handover person using the number in the written agreement. If the property is inaccessible, unsafe, already occupied, materially different from the listing, or missing essential services, preserve evidence before accepting revised terms.

- Photograph or record the entrance, condition, missing inventory, and utility problems.
- Send a concise written message stating the problem and requested remedy.
- Give a reasonable but specific response checkpoint.
- Do not pay an unverified person or transfer an additional large amount under pressure.
- If access cannot be restored, activate the temporary accommodation backup.
- Keep receipts for reasonable emergency accommodation and transport.
- Notify the booking platform, property manager, employer, institution, insurer, or payment provider where relevant.
- For immediate danger, leave the property and use the appropriate emergency channel.

The budget is significantly over plan

Separate one-time arrival costs from a recurring monthly shortfall. Reconcile bank records, receipts, deposits, and cash spending before deciding what to cut. Protect lawful-stay requirements, safe housing, essential food, health needs, necessary transport, and the emergency reserve.

- Calculate the amount and cause of the variance by category.
- Stop optional purchases and delay nonessential subscriptions or upgrades.
- Correct the largest flexible expense first.
- Check whether exchange fees, deposits, utility setup, or repeated transport caused the difference.
- Contact providers early if a payment date may be missed; obtain any arrangement in writing.
- Do not use high-cost short-term borrowing to preserve an unsustainable routine.

- Reset the next four weeks using actual spending, not the original estimate.
- Escalate to a trusted financial or contractual adviser where obligations cannot be met.

Travel is delayed, cancelled, or rerouted

Confirm the new schedule directly with the carrier and update every dependency: airport transfer, accommodation handover, connecting travel, work or study start, and any appointment. Keep the revised itinerary and all delay evidence together.

- Do not travel to the airport based only on an old confirmation.
- Notify all affected contacts using one clear message with the new expected arrival.
- Check baggage handling and connection instructions.
- Preserve boarding passes, notices, receipts, and carrier reference numbers.
- Use the planned late-arrival or overnight fallback if handover becomes impossible.
- Keep medication, documents, chargers, and one change of clothing in hand luggage.
- Review insurance or carrier procedures before making replacement purchases.

Baggage is delayed, damaged, or lost

Report the problem before leaving the baggage-claim area where possible and obtain a written case or property-irregularity reference. Photograph damage and retain baggage tags and boarding documents. Give the address where delivery can be accepted and keep the phone reachable.

- List the bag's identifying features and its essential contents from memory or your packing inventory.
- Buy only reasonable immediate necessities and keep itemized receipts.
- Do not place passports, irreplaceable records, essential medication, valuables, or all payment methods in checked baggage.
- Track the case using the official carrier or handling channel.
- Notify the insurer within the required time where applicable.
- Record every update, promised delivery date, and final outcome.

A payment method or bank account stops working

Move to the backup method and check whether the issue is a security block, transaction limit, merchant problem, network failure, insufficient balance, expired card, or currency setting. Contact the institution using a trusted number already associated with the account.

- Do not share passwords, one-time codes, PINs, or full security credentials.
- Lock a lost card immediately and review recent transactions.
- Preserve enough accessible funds for accommodation, food, transport, and communication.
- Use a second lawful payment route rather than repeating failed transactions many times.
- Document disputed charges and submit them through the provider's official process.
- Delay large transfers until the recipient and written purpose are independently verified.

Utilities, internet, heating, or water are unavailable

Determine whether the problem affects only the property, the whole building, or the surrounding area. Check the lease, account responsibility, meter status, building notice, and provider outage information. Report the exact problem and obtain a service reference.

- Contact building management or the named account holder first where appropriate.
- Do not operate gas, electrical, boiler, or building equipment you do not understand.
- Use the mobile-data or alternate-workspace backup for a temporary internet interruption.
- If loss of heat, water, or power creates a health or safety risk, relocate temporarily.
- Photograph meter readings and visible faults without touching unsafe equipment.
- Keep a log of outage time, reports, technician visits, and restored service.

You become ill or need urgent help

For a life-threatening illness, injury, accident, fire, or other immediate emergency, call 112. Stay calm, give the precise location and a nearby landmark, describe the emergency clearly, provide a callback number, and do not end the call unless instructed. For non-urgent care, use the provider and insurance process identified in your health plan.

- Carry or access your identity, insurance, medication, allergy, and emergency-contact information.
- Do not take unfamiliar medication without appropriate professional advice.
- Ask the insurer whether pre-authorization, designated facilities, or reimbursement documents apply.
- Take prescriptions and medication packaging to the consultation where useful.
- Save clinical records, invoices, reports, and payment receipts.
- If language support is needed for significant medical decisions, arrange appropriate assistance.

An immigration deadline, appointment, or application is at risk

Do not wait until the final day. Review the submitted application, lawful-stay dates, appointment notice, passport validity, missing-document request, and payment evidence. Use the official application channel or YIMER 157 for current migration information; record the instruction and act promptly.

- Confirm whether the issue is non-submission, missed appointment, missing evidence, fee problem, address problem, or delayed result.
- Keep screenshots or copies of the official status and all reference numbers.
- Ask what remedial step is accepted and by what deadline.
- Do not assume travel is permitted while a case is pending; confirm officially.
- Escalate promptly if the lawful-stay end date is approaching.
- Use qualified legal advice for complex or disputed status issues.

Phone, SIM, or internet access fails

Use a trusted Wi-Fi connection or the backup device or SIM to contact essential people. Confirm whether the issue is coverage, account balance, device compatibility, registration, damaged equipment, or provider outage. Keep critical addresses, booking details, and contact numbers available offline so the failure does not block travel or accommodation access.

A scam, impersonation, or suspicious request appears

Pause the transaction. Verify the person or organization through a separate trusted channel. Warning signs include urgent payment pressure, account changes sent only by message, demands for one-time codes, requests to hand over original documents, refusal to

provide written terms, or an offer that cannot be independently confirmed.

- Do not click unexpected payment or verification links.
- Confirm bank details or recipient identity using a known number.
- Save messages, numbers, receipts, and account details as evidence.
- Contact the payment provider immediately if money or card information was exposed.
- Change affected passwords from a trusted device and review account activity.
- Report the incident to the appropriate platform, provider, or authority.

Earthquake or other major disruption affects the area

Follow current official emergency instructions and use 112 for immediate life-threatening emergencies. Move away from obvious hazards when safe to do so, check household members, take the emergency kit if evacuation is required, and use the agreed assembly and communication plan. Do not re-enter a visibly damaged property until competent authorities indicate it is safe.

Escalation Checklist

- ☐ Immediate safety and essential access are protected.
- ☐ The problem is described in one factual sentence.
- ☐ The responsible party and backup contact are identified.
- ☐ Evidence is stored securely.
- ☐ A case, ticket, or reference number has been obtained.
- ☐ The promised action and checkpoint time are recorded.
- ☐ A fallback is ready if the issue is not resolved.
- ☐ Relevant insurer, employer, institution, or official authority has been notified.
- ☐ Financial exposure is limited.
- ☐ The final outcome and lessons learned are added to the relocation file.

Relocation Incident Log

Date / time	Problem and impact	Contact / reference	Action and deadline	Outcome
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
-	-	-	-	-
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

–	–		–	–
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
–	–	_____	–	–
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
–	–	_____	–	–
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
–	–	_____	–	–

A critical document is missing

Identify the exact document, issuing authority, accepted format, and deadline. Ask the responsible official channel whether a replacement, certified copy, or additional evidence is accepted. Record the response and avoid submitting altered or unverified material.

Housing access fails on arrival

Use the written delay and handover procedure. Contact the authorized person, preserve messages and payment evidence, and move to the pre-identified temporary backup if access cannot be restored promptly. Avoid making a second large payment without verified written terms.

The budget is significantly over planned.

Separate one-time arrival costs from recurring overspend. Correct the largest flexible category first, protect compliance, housing, health, and safety costs, and do not use the emergency reserve to hide an unsustainable monthly pattern.

Your Next Step

You now have the roadmap. But if you want us to drive the car, we're here to help.

🛑 Overwhelmed by Module 2 (Visas)? Book our \$99 Visa & Paperwork Guidance.

🏠 Stressed about Module 3 (Housing)? Let us shortlist and negotiate your apartment for \$449.

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